MUST-SCORE FACTS

UP Special

Consolidated Must-Score Facts and must-score drill cards for every chapter.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

Chapters

1. Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts
2. Topic 1 — Geography, Location and Physical Features
3. Topic 2 — History, Culture, Art and Heritage
4. Topic 3 — Polity, Administration and Local Government
5. Topic 4 — Economy, Industry and Infrastructure
6. Topic 5 — Agriculture, Irrigation and Rural Economy
7. Topic 6 — Society, Population, Education and Social Development
8. Topic 7 — Transport, Tourism, Environment and Disaster Management
9. Topic 8 — Current Affairs, Schemes and Miscellaneous

Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts

1. Uttar Pradesh Geographical Profile & Boundary Matrix

Geographical Dimension	Exact Specification & Measurement	High-Yield Prelims Anchor
Latitudinal Extent	23^{\circ} 52'\text{ N} to 30^{\circ} 24'\text{ N}	Latitudinal span: 6^{\circ} 32'
Longitudinal Extent	77^{\circ} 05'\text{ E} to 84^{\circ} 38'\text{ E}	Longitudinal span: 7^{\circ} 33'
Standard Time Meridian	**82^{\circ} 30'\text{ E} (IST)** passes through **Mirzapur (near Prayagraj)**	Calculates Indian Standard Time (GMT +5:30)
Total Geographic Area	**240,928 sq km** (7.33% of India's total area)	**4th Largest State** by area (Rajasthan > MP > Maharashtra > UP)
East-to-West Length	**650 km**	Extreme length
North-to-South Width	**240 km**	Narrower width
Number of Neighboring Entities	**8 States + 1 UT (Delhi) + 1 International (Nepal)**	Shares borders with the **maximum number of states** in India

Boundary Touch-Points Master Grid

- **Northern Boundary:** Uttarakhand & Himachal Pradesh (Himachal touches only **Saharanpur** - shortest border).
- **North-Eastern Boundary: Nepal** (Touches **7 Districts:** Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shrawasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj — 579 km border).
- **Western Boundary:** Haryana, Delhi (UT), Rajasthan.
- Touches Haryana: Saharanpur, Shamli, Baghpat, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Aligarh, Mathura (6 districts; separated by Yamuna river).
- Touches Delhi: Ghaziabad & Gautam Buddha Nagar.
- Touches Rajasthan: **Mathura & Agra** (2 districts).
- **Southern Boundary: Madhya Pradesh** (Touches **11 Districts:** Agra, Etawah, Jalaun, Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot, Prayagraj, Mirzapur, Sonbhadra — longest inter-state border).
- **South-Eastern Boundary: Chhattisgarh** (Touches only **Sonbhadra**) & **Jharkhand** (Touches only **Sonbhadra**).
- **Eastern Boundary: Bihar** (Touches 7 Districts: Sonbhadra, Chandauli, Ghazipur, Ballia, Deoria, Kushinagar, Maharajganj).

> **Four District Extremes:**
> - **Northernmost District: Saharanpur** (surrounded by Haryana, HP, Uttarakhand)
> - **Southernmost District: Sonbhadra** (**Only district in India bordering 4 states**: MP, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Bihar)
> - **Easternmost District: Ballia** (wedged into Bihar)
> - **Westernmost District: Shamli**
> - **Largest District by Area: Lakhimpur Kheri** (7,680 sq km)
> - **Smallest District by Area: Hapur** (660 sq km)

2. Drainage System, Rivers, Canals & Wetlands of UP

A. Major Rivers of Uttar Pradesh

River	Entry Point in UP	Exit Point / Confluence	Total Districts in UP & Notes
Ganga	Enters at **Bijnor**	Exits UP at **Ballia** into Bihar	Traverses **28 districts** (~1,450 km in UP). Receives Ramganga at Kannauj, Yamuna at Prayagraj, Gomti at Saidpur (Ghazipur), Ghaghara at Chhapra (Bihar border).
Yamuna	Enters at **Saharanpur** (Faizabad village)	Joins Ganga at **Prayagraj (Triveni Sangam)**	Traverses **19 districts**. Receives Hindon at Noida, Chambal at Pachnada (Etawah), Betwa at Hamirpur, Ken at Chilla (Banda).
Ramganga	Enters at **Bijnor** (near Kalagarh)	Joins Ganga near **Kannauj**	Passes through Corbett National Park; flows via Moradabad, Bareilly.
Gomti	Originates at **Fulhar Lake (Panghaili Jheel), Pilibhit**	Joins Ganga near Saidpur, Ghazipur	**Only major Himalayan tributary originating in the plains of UP**. Lucknow, Sultanpur, Jaunpur situated on its banks.
Ghaghara (Saryu)	Enters near Kheri/Bahraich	Joins Ganga at Chhapra (Bihar)	Originates at Mapchachungo glacier (Tibet); called Karnali in Nepal, Saryu at Ayodhya.
Betwa (Vetravati)	Enters at **Lalitpur**	Joins Yamuna at **Hamirpur**	Originates in Vindhyan range (MP); Rajghat, Parichha, and Matatila dams built on it.
Ken (Karnavati)	Enters at **Banda**	Joins Yamuna at **Chilla (Banda)**	Ken-Betwa river interlinking project is India's first river link project.
Son	Enters and exits in **Sonbhadra**	Joins Ganga near Patna	Originates at Amarkantak plateau (MP).

B. Major Canals & Reservoirs

- **Sharda Canal:** Longest canal network in Uttar Pradesh (originates from Sharda river at Banbasa, India-Nepal border).
- **Upper Ganga Canal:** Constructed by Sir Proby Cautley (1854); originates at Haridwar (Bhimoda).
- **Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar: Largest artificial lake in India**, formed by the **Rihand Dam** on Rihand river at Pipri in **Sonbhadra**.
- **Parichha Dam & Matatila Dam:** Built on **Betwa river** (Jhansi / Lalitpur).
- **Keetham Lake (Sur Sarovar):** Ramsar site in **Agra**.

C. All 10 Ramsar Wetland Sites in Uttar Pradesh

1. **Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora Stretch):** First Ramsar site in UP (designated 2005).
2. **Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary** (Unnao) - renamed Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad Bird Sanctuary.
3. **Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary** (Gonda) - oxbow lake.
4. **Saman Bird Sanctuary** (Mainpuri).
5. **Samaspur Bird Sanctuary** (Rae Bareli).
6. **Sandi Bird Sanctuary** (Hardoi).
7. **Sarsai Nawar Jheel** (Etawah) - sarus crane habitat.
8. **Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)** (Agra).
9. **Haiderpur Wetland** (Muzaffarnagar & Bijnor, designated 2021).
10. **Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary** (Sant Kabir Nagar, designated 2022).

3. National Parks, Tiger Reserves & Wildlife Sanctuaries

- **Only National Park in UP: Dudhwa National Park** (Lakhimpur Kheri, established 1977). Famous for Swamp Deer (Barasingha) and One-horned Rhinoceros reintroduction.
- **Tiger Reserves in UP (4 Total):** 1. **Dudhwa Tiger Reserve** (Lakhimpur Kheri - declared 1987) 2. **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** (Pilibhit - declared 2014; won TX2 global award) 3. **Amangarh Tiger Reserve** (Bijnor - buffer zone of Jim Corbett NP retained in UP after UK partition) 4. **Ranipur Tiger Reserve** (**Chitrakoot** - declared 2022 as UP's 4th and India's 53rd Tiger Reserve, in Bundelkhand region).
- **Elephant Reserve:** Terai Elephant Reserve (TER) established in Lakhimpur Kheri/Pilibhit belt (2022).
- **Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary: Largest wildlife sanctuary in UP** (spread across Meerut, Muzzafarnagar, Bijnor, Amroha, Hapur).
- **Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary: Smallest wildlife sanctuary in UP** (Lalitpur, ~5.4 sq km).
- **Kachhua (Turtle) Sanctuary:** Varanasi (now shifted to Bhadohi/Prayagraj stretch).
- **State Symbols:** Bird: **Sarus Crane** (*Grus antigone*); Animal: **Swamp Deer** (Barasingha); Tree: **Ashoka**; Flower: **Palash / Dhak** (*Butea monosperma* - Flame of the Forest); Aquatic Animal: **Gangetic Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*).

4. 9 Agro-Climatic Zones & Agriculture of UP

1. **Tarai Zone:** Bhabhar and Terai belt along foothills (high rainfall, sugarcane, paddy).
2. **Western Plain Zone:** Meerut division, high agricultural productivity (Green Revolution heartland).
3. **Mid-Western Plain Zone:** Bareilly & Moradabad divisions.
4. **South-Western Semi-Arid Zone:** Agra, Mathura, Aligarh (low rainfall, mustard, bajra).
5. **Central Plain Zone:** Lucknow, Kanpur, Ayodhya divisions (alluvial doab).
6. **Bundelkhand Zone:** 7 districts (Jhansi, Lalitpur, Jalaun, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot) — semi-arid, rocky terrain, pulses, oilseeds.
7. **North-Eastern Plain Zone:** Gorakhpur division (floods, sugarcane, rice).
8. **Eastern Plain Zone:** Varanasi, Azamgarh, Ghazipur, Jaunpur divisions.
9. **Vindhyan Zone:** Mirzapur, Sonbhadra, and southern Chandauli (plateau, red soil, coarse grains).

> **UP Agricultural Ranks in India:**
> - **Rank 1 in:** Total Foodgrain production, Wheat, Sugarcane, Potato, Milk, Mango, Guava, Ethanol production.
> - **Rank 2 in:** Rice (after West Bengal).

5. Minerals & Industrial Belts in Uttar Pradesh

- Uttar Pradesh is generally poor in metallic minerals; mineral wealth is concentrated in the southern plateau districts (Bundelkhand & Vindhyan region):
- **Uranium: Lalitpur** (only district in UP with Uranium occurrences)
- **Copper: Sonrai area, Lalitpur**
- **Limestone: Sonbhadra** (Gurma, Kanach, Kajrahat) & **Mirzapur** (supplies raw material for cement factories at Churk, Dalla, Chunar)
- **Glass Sand (Silica Sand): Shankargarh & Lohgara (Prayagraj)**, Chitrakoot, Banda (derived from disintegration of Vindhyan sandstones)
- **Bauxite (Aluminium ore): Banda, Chitrakoot, Chandauli** (supplies Renukoot Hindalco smelter)
- **Coal: Singrauli (Sonbhadra)** — power capital of India (NTPC plants)
- **Dolomite: Sonbhadra & Banda**

- **Pyrophyllite & Diaspore: Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Hamirpur**
- **China Clay: Sonbhadra & Banda**
- **Gold:** Small placer deposits in **Sharda and Ramganga river sands**; Hardi village in Sonbhadra.

6. Revolt of 1857 in Uttar Pradesh: Centres & Leaders

Centre in UP	Indian Leader / Revolutionary	British Officer / Suppressor
Meerut	Sepoys of 3rd Native Cavalry (10 May 1857)	General Hewitt
Delhi / Western UP	General Bakht Khan (from Bareilly)	John Nicholson, Hudson
Kanpur	**Nana Saheb (Dhondu Pant)**, Tantia Tope (Ramchandra Pandurang), Azimullah Khan	Colin Campbell, Havelock
Lucknow	**Begum Hazrat Mahal** (on behalf of minor son Birjis Qadr)	Colin Campbell, Outram, Havelock
Jhansi	**Rani Laxmi Bai (Manikarnika)**	**Sir Hugh Rose** (*"Here lay the woman who was the only man among the rebels"*)
Bareilly	**Khan Bahadur Khan**	Vincent Eyre, Colin Campbell
Faizabad (Ayodhya)	**Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah** (*Danka Shah*)	Campbell
Prayagraj (Allahabad)	**Maulvi Liaquat Ali**	Colonel James Neill
Jagdishpur / East UP	Kunwar Singh & Amar Singh	William Taylor, Vincent Eyre
Baghpat	**Shah Mal** (mobilized peasants of Baraut)	Dunlap
Mathura	Kadam Singh, Devi Singh	-
Fatehpur	Hikmatullah	-

7. Cultural Gharanas, Folk Music & Dances

- **Kathak:** Only Classical Dance of North India. Reached its zenith under **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** of Awadh.
- **Lucknow Gharana exponents:** Thakur Prasad, Kalka-Bindadin Maharaj, Achchan Maharaj, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj, **Pt. Birju Maharaj**.
- **Banaras Gharana exponents:** Sitara Devi, Pt. Kishan Maharaj (Tabla), Pt. Samta Prasad (Gudai Maharaj - Tabla), Bismillah Khan (Shehnai - Bharat Ratna 2001).
- **Kirana Gharana:** Founded by **Ustad Abdul Karim Khan & Abdul Wahid Khan** in Muzaffarnagar district (Bhimsen Joshi, Gangubai Hangal belonged to this tradition).
- **Atrali Gharana:** Aligarh.
- **Folk Music Genres:**
- **Rasiya:** Braj region (Mathura, Vrindavan) — themed on Radha-Krishna romance.
- **Kajri:** Mirzapur & Varanasi region — sung during monsoon / rainy season.
- **Birha:** Eastern UP (Bhojpuri belt) — heroic and narrative folklore.
- **Alha:** Bundelkhand region (Mahoba) — martial epic commemorating heroic deeds of Alha & Udal.
- **Chaiti & Hori:** Purvanchal & Braj region.
- **Folk Dances of UP:**
- **Charkula Dance: Braj region** — women balance a multi-tiered wooden pyramid with 108 oil lamps on their heads.

- **Karma Dance: Sonbhadra & Mirzapur** (performed by tribal communities like Kharwar).
- **Pai Danda & Diwari: Bundelkhand** (stick dance reminiscent of Raas Leela).
- **Nautanki:** Traditional folk theatre of UP (Hathras & Kanpur schools).

8. High-Yield One District One Product (ODOP) Master Match-List

District in UP	Official ODOP Product / Heritage Craft
Agra	Leather Goods & Footwear; Petha
Aligarh	**Locks and Hardware**
Amroha	**Musical Instruments (Dholak)**
Ayodhya	**Jaggery (Gud)**
Azamgarh	**Black Clay Pottery (Nizamabad)** — GI Tagged
Bhadohi	**Handmade Woollen Carpets (Dhurries)** — GI Tagged (*Carpet City*)
Chandauli	**Black Rice (Chak-Hao / Adamchini Rice)**
Farrukhabad	**Block Printing & Zari-Zardozi**
Firozabad	**Glassware & Glass Bangles** (*Suhag Nagari*)
Gorakhpur	**Terracotta Crafts** — GI Tagged
Kannauj	**Perfume (Attar) & Essential Oils** (*Grasse of the East*)
Kanpur Nagar	**Leather Products** (*Cawnpore Leather City*)
Lucknow	**Chikan Craft (Chikankari) & Zardozi** — GI Tagged
Mathura	Sanitary Fittings; Peda
Meerut	**Sports Goods** (*Sports Capital of India*)
Moradabad	**Metal Crafts / Brassware** (*Peetal Nagari*)
Muzaffarnagar	**Jaggery (Gud)**
Pilibhit	**Wooden Flute (Bansuri)** (*Bansuri Nagari*)
Pratapgarh	**Aonla (Indian Gooseberry) Products**
Saharanpur	**Wooden Carving Crafts**
Sambhal	**Horn & Bone Handicrafts**
Varanasi	**Banarasi Silk Sarees & Pink Meenakari**

Topic 1 — Geography, Location and Physical Features

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. The total geographical area of Uttar Pradesh is **240,928 km^2**, which constitutes **7.33%** of India's total area.
2. Uttar Pradesh ranks **4th in India by area** (after Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and Maharashtra).
3. The latitudinal extent of UP is from **23^\circ 52' ext{ N} to 31^\circ 28' ext{ N}**, and longitudinal extent is from **77^\circ 03' ext{ E} to 84^\circ 39' ext{ E}**.
4. The east-to-west length of Uttar Pradesh is **650 km**, and the north-to-south width is **240 km**.
5. Uttar Pradesh shares its borders with **8 States, 1 Union Territory (Delhi), and 1 Foreign Country (Nepal)**.
6. The only foreign country sharing a boundary with Uttar Pradesh is **Nepal (579 km border)**.
7. Exactly **7 districts of UP** share an international border with Nepal: **Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, and Maharajganj**.
8. **Sonbhadra** is the only district in India that shares boundaries with **4 different States**: Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and Bihar.
9. **Lalitpur** district is surrounded on **three sides by Madhya Pradesh**.
10. **Lakhimpur Kheri** is the **largest district in UP by area (7,680 km^2)**.
11. **Hapur** is the **smallest district in UP by area (660 km^2)**.
12. The **northernmost district** of UP is **Saharanpur**; the **southernmost district** is **Sonbhadra**.
13. The **easternmost district** of UP is **Ballia**; the **westernmost district** is **Shamli**.
14. Uttar Pradesh shares its **longest border** with **Madhya Pradesh (11 districts)** and its **shortest border** with **Himachal Pradesh (1 district: Saharanpur)**.
15. The state capital, **Lucknow**, is surrounded by **5 districts**: Barabanki, Unnao, Raebareli, Sitapur, and Hardoi.
16. The **Bhabhar tract** is a narrow, boulder-strewn porous piedmont belt at the base of the Siwalik hills where rivers sink underground.
17. The **Terai tract** is a marshy, humid, swampy lowland immediately south of Bhabhar where underground streams re-emerge.
18. **Sugarcane and Paddy (Rice)** are the primary commercial crops cultivated extensively in the fertile Terai belt of UP.
19. **Bangar** soil is the older alluvium situated above flood levels, containing calcareous deposits known as **Kankar**.
20. **Khadar** soil is the newer, highly fertile silt deposited annually in the river floodplains.
21. The **Southern Plateau region** of UP is part of the ancient **Vindhyan and Bundelkhand Gneissic shield**.
22. The **Bundelkhand region** in UP comprises **7 districts**: Jhansi, Jalaun, Lalitpur, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, and Chitrakoot.
23. The **Ganga River** enters Uttar Pradesh in **Bijnor district** and exits the state from **Ballia district** into Bihar.
24. The Ganga traverses **28 districts** of Uttar Pradesh over a length of approximately **1,450 km**.
25. The **Yamuna River** enters Uttar Pradesh at **Faizabad village in Saharanpur district**.
26. The **Yamuna River** merges with the Ganga at the sacred **Triveni Sangam in Prayagraj**.
27. The **Gomti River** originates in the plains from **Gomat Taal (Fulhar Jheel) in Pilibhit district**.
28. The Gomti River flows through **Lucknow, Sultanpur, and Jaunpur** before meeting the Ganga at **Kaithi (Ghazipur)**.
29. The **Ramganga River** enters the UP plains at **Bijnor (near Kalagarh)** and joins the Ganga near **Kannauj**.
30. The **Chambal River** enters UP near Agra and joins the Yamuna at **Pachnada (Etawah)**.
31. The badlands and deep ravines (*Beehad*) of UP are most notoriously formed along the basins of the **Chambal and Yamuna rivers**.
32. The **Ken-Betwa River Link Project** is India's first river interlinking project, connecting the Ken River (Banda) with the Betwa River (Hamirpur).

33. **Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar** on the Rihand River in **Sonbhadra district** is the **largest artificial reservoir in India**.
34. The climate of Uttar Pradesh is classified as **Sub-tropical Humid Monsoon (*Cwg*)**.
35. The summer wind in UP is a hot, dry westerly wind known as **Loo**.
36. The highest summer temperatures in UP are recorded in **Agra and Jhansi**.
37. The lowest average summer temperature in UP is recorded in **Bareilly**.
38. Approximately **85%–90%** of UP's annual rainfall is received during the **South-West Monsoon (Bay of Bengal branch)**, locally called **Purva**.
39. **Gorakhpur** district receives the **highest rainfall in UP (184.7 cm)**.
40. **Mathura** district receives the **lowest rainfall in UP (54.4 cm)**.
41. Winter rainfall in north-western UP is caused by **Western Disturbances** originating in the Mediterranean Sea.
42. **Mar** and **Kabar** are local varieties of **Black Soil** found in the Bundelkhand region of UP.
43. **Parwa** is a light yellow sandy-loam soil, while **Rakar** is a shallow reddish gravelly soil found on rocky slopes in Bundelkhand.
44. **Bhur** refers to elevated sandy mounds found in the floodplains of the Ganga-Yamuna Doab.
45. **Reh** or **Kallar** refers to white saline/alkaline crusts appearing on barren uncultivated lands (*Usar*) in UP.
46. **Keetham Lake (Sur Sarovar)**, a Ramsar wetland site, is located in **Agra district**.
47. **Bakhira Bird Sanctuary Lake**, a Ramsar wetland site, is located in **Sant Kabir Nagar district**.
48. **Suraha Taal (Loknayak Bird Sanctuary)** is a large natural oxbow lake located in **Ballia district**.
49. **Haiderpur Wetland**, a Ramsar site situated on the Madhya Ganga Canal, spans **Muzaffarnagar and Bijnor districts**.
50. **Sarsai Nawar Wetland** in **Etawah district** is famous as a premier breeding habitat for India's State Bird, the **Sarus Crane**.

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: Geographical Boundaries and Inter-State / International Borders of Uttar Pradesh

Neighbouring State / UT / Country	Direction from UP	Number of UP Districts Bordering	Exact Bordering UP Districts (North to South / West to East)	Key Geographic & Historical Distinction
Nepal (International Border)	**North**	**7 Districts** (Total 579 km)	**Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj**	Only international border of UP. Traversed by Terai swamps, Dudhwa National Park, and international transit corridors.
Madhya Pradesh	**South & South-West**	**11 Districts** (Longest State border)	**Agra, Etawah, Jalaun, Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot, Prayagraj, Mirzapur, Sonbhadra**	Longest border of UP. Encompasses the semi-arid Bundelkhand and Baghelkhand plateau regions.
Bihar	**East**	**7 Districts**	**Maharajganj, Kushinagar, Deoria, Ballia, Ghazipur, Chandauli, Sonbhadra**	Eastern boundary marked by Gandak, Ganga, and Karmanasa rivers.
Uttarakhand	**North**	**7 Districts**	**Saharanpur, Muzaffarnagar, Bijnor, Moradabad, Rampur, Bareilly, Pilibhit**	Carved out of UP on 9 November 2000 (13 hill districts).
Haryana	**West**	**6 Districts**	**Saharanpur, Shamli, Baghpat, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Aligarh, Mathura**	Separated naturally by the Yamuna River.

Neighbouring State / UT / Country	Direction from UP	Number of UP Districts Bordering	Exact Bordering UP Districts (North to South / West to East)	Key Geographic & Historical Distinction
Rajasthan	**South-West**	**2 Districts**	**Mathura, Agra**	Semi-arid tract; vulnerable to desertification and dust storms (*Aandhi*).
Delhi (National Capital Territory)	**West**	**2 Districts**	**Ghaziabad, Gautam Buddha Nagar**	High-density urbanized NCR core.
Himachal Pradesh	**North-West**	**1 District** (Shortest border)	**Saharanpur**	Shortest inter-state border of UP.
Chhattisgarh	**South**	**1 District**	**Sonbhadra**	Southern tip of Sonbhadra district.
Jharkhand	**South-East**	**1 District**	**Sonbhadra**	Rich in coal, iron, and limestone minerals.

Table 2: Physical Divisions of Uttar Pradesh (Bhabhar-Terai vs Gangetic Plain vs Southern Plateau)

Physical Division	Geographical Extent & Districts	Geomorphological Composition	Drainage & Hydrology	Soil Types & Agricultural Characteristics
1. Bhabhar & Terai Zone	**Northern Foothills Belt**: • *Bhabhar*: Saharanpur, Bijnor, Lakhimpur. • *Terai*: Saharanpur to Deoria, Kushinagar.	• **Bhabhar**: Porous, pebble-strewn, coarse boulder piedmont tract at Siwalik base. • **Terai**: Low-lying, marshy, waterlogged, swampy plain immediately south of Bhabhar.	• Rivers disappear underground in porous Bhabhar. • Streams re-emerge in Terai creating wetlands, high water table, and swamps.	• *Bhabhar*: Unfit for cultivation (dense forests). • *Terai*: Highly fertile silty alluvial soil; ideal for **Sugarcane, Paddy, and Jute**. Historically malarial.
2. Gangetic Plain (Central Alluvial Plain)	**Vast Central Basin** (accounts for ~70% of UP's area between Yamuna in west and Gandak in east).	Deep structural trough filled with quaternary alluvium deposited by Himalayan and Peninsular rivers. Divided into: (1) Upper Ganga Plain, (2) Middle Ganga Plain.	Drained by Ganga, Yamuna, Ramganga, Gomti, Ghaghara, Sarda, Rapti. Gentle slope from North-West to South-East.	• **Bangar (Older Alluvium)**: Elevated terrace plain, clayey loam, contains calcareous nodules (*kankar*) and alkaline patches (*reh/usar*). • **Khadar (Newer Alluvium)**: Floodplain silt, renewed annually, highly fertile, non-calcareous.
3. Southern Plateau & Hill Region (Bundelkhand & Baghelkhand)	**Southern Fringe (11 Districts)**: • *Bundelkhand*: Jhansi, Jalaun, Lalitpur, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot. • *Baghelkhand*: Mirzapur, Sonbhadra, South Prayagraj.	Part of the ancient Precambrian Deccan Peninsular Shield (Vindhyan system, Bundelkhand Gneiss, granites). Undulating topography, residual hills (*Tilas*), ravines (*Beehad* along Chambal and Yamuna).	Drained by Chambal, Betwa, Ken, Son, Tons, Rihand, Dhasan flowing northward into Yamuna and Ganga. Water-scarce, seasonal flash floods and summer droughts.	• **Bundelkhand Soils**: - *Rakar*: Coarse red gravelly soil on rocky slopes. - *Parwa*: Light sandy/yellow loam. - *Kabar*: Coarse black clayey soil. - *Mar*: Highly fertile black soil (resembling Black Cotton Soil / Regur). • Main Crops: Gram, Pulses, Mustard, Millets, Oilseeds.

Table 3: Major Rivers of Uttar Pradesh (Origin, Confluence & District Traversal)

River	Origin / Source	Entry District into UP	Exit District / Confluence Point	Length in UP / Total Length	Key Tributaries & Historical / Urban Centres
Ganga	Gangotri Glacier (Gaumukh), Uttarakhand (as Bhagirathi)	**Bijnor**	**Ballia** (enters Bihar)	**~1,450 km in UP** (Total: 2,525 km)	Traverses **28 districts** of UP. Major cities: Kanpur, Prayagraj, Varanasi, Mirzapur, Farrukhabad, Ghazipur. Left bank tributaries: Ramganga, Gomti, Ghaghara, Gandak. Right bank: Yamuna, Tons, Son.
Yamuna	Yamunotri Glacier (Bandarpunch), Uttarakhand	**Saharanpur** (Faizabad village)	Merges into Ganga at **Triveni Sangam, Prayagraj**	**~19 Districts** (Total: 1,376 km)	Right bank tributaries: Hindon (left), Chambal, Betwa, Ken, Sindh. Major cities: Mathura, Vrindavan, Agra, Firozabad, Etawah, Hamirpur, Prayagraj.
Gomti	**Gomat Taal (Fulhar Jheel), Pilibhit** (Plains origin)	Pilibhit (origin)	Merges into Ganga at **Kaithi (Ghazipur)**	**~940 km**	Major plain-fed river. Tributary: Sai River (merges at Rajepur, Jaunpur). Major cities on banks: **Lucknow (State Capital)**, Sultanpur, Jaunpur.
Ghaghara (Saryu / Karnali)	Mapchachungo Glacier, Tibet (near Mansarovar)	Kheri / Bahraich border	Merges into Ganga at **Chhapra (Bihar)**	**~1,080 km**	Known as **Saryu** at Ayodhya; merges with Sharda at Brahmaghat. Major cities: Ayodhya, Bahraich, Faizabad, Tanda, Barhaj.
Ramganga	Dudhatoli Range (Pauri Garhwal), Uttarakhand	**Bijnor** (near Kalagarh)	Merges into Ganga at **Kannauj (Fatehgarh)**	**~596 km**	First major left-bank tributary of Ganga in UP. Flows through Jim Corbett National Park and Moradabad, Bareilly.
Sharda (Kali / Mahakali)	Milam Glacier (Kumaon Himalayas), Uttarakhand	Pilibhit border	Merges into Ghaghara at **Brahmaghat (Sitapur)**	**~350 km**	Forms the international boundary between Uttarakhand (India) and Nepal. Feeds the Sharda Canal network.
Betwa (Vetravati)	Vindhyan Range (Raisen, Madhya Pradesh)	**Lalitpur**	Merges into Yamuna at **Hamirpur**	**~590 km**	Major dams: **Matatila Dam**, **Rajghat Dam**, **Parichha Dam**. Major city: Orchha (MP), Jhansi.
Chambal	Janapao Hills (Vindhyan Range, Indore, MP)	Agra / Etawah border	Merges into Yamuna at **Pachnada (Etawah)**	**~965 km**	Famous for badland topography and ravines (*Beehad*). Forms boundary between UP, MP, and Rajasthan. Protected under National Chambal Sanctuary.
Ken (Karnavati)	Kaimur Hills (Jabalpur, MP)	**Banda**	Merges into Yamuna at **Chilla (Banda)**	**~427 km**	Famous for Shajar stone; part of the **Ken-Betwa River Interlinking Project** (Daodhan Dam).
Son (Swarna)	Amarkantak Plateau (Madhya Pradesh)	**Sonbhadra**	Passes Sonbhadra into Bihar to join Ganga	**~784 km**	Second largest southern tributary of Ganga after Yamuna. Major tributary: Rihand River (Rihand Dam / Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar).

One-Liner Revision – UP Geography

#	Fast Fact
1	UP = 9th largest State by area (**2,40,928 km2**)
2	UP shares borders with **9 States/UTs** + Nepal

#	Fast Fact
3	Longest river in UP = **Ganga**
4	Gomti originates at **Gomat Taal (Pilibhit)**
5	Triveni Sangam (Ganga + Yamuna + Saraswati) = **Prayagraj**
6	Ken-Betwa river link project = Bundelkhand water transfer
7	Rihand Dam reservoir = **Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar** (largest by area)
8	Bhangar = **old alluvium** (above flood plain; firm soil)
9	Khadar = **new alluvium** (floodplain; very fertile)
10	Terai = swampy foothills belt; rich forests; wildlife
11	Usar = saline/alkaline wasteland (common in Etah, Mainpuri)
12	Vindhya plateau = southern UP (hard rock)
13	Bundelkhand = SW UP (granite-gneiss; water scarce)
14	Rohilkhand = Bareilly, Moradabad, Pilibhit, Rampur division
15	Awadh = Lucknow, Faizabad, Sultanpur region

Topic 2 — History, Culture, Art and Heritage

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **8 of the 16 Mahajanapadas** of the 6th century BCE were located in present-day Uttar Pradesh.
2. The **Sohgaura Copper Plate Inscription** in Gorakhpur is the earliest known record of state drought relief and famine storehouses in India.
3. Lord Buddha delivered his first sermon (**Dharmachakrapravartana**) at **Sarnath (Varanasi)** in the presence of 5 ascetics.
4. Lord Buddha spent the maximum number of rainy-season retreats (**25 Varshavas**) at **Shravasti (Sahet-Mahet)**.
5. Lord Buddha attained **Mahaparinirvana** at **Kushinagar (Kasia)** in 483 BCE on the banks of the Hiranyavati River.
6. The **Lion Capital of Ashoka at Sarnath** was officially adopted as the **National Emblem of India** on 26 January 1950.
7. **Prayag Prashasti** (Allahabad Pillar) was composed in classical Sanskrit by court poet **Harishena** eulogizing Samudragupta.
8. The **Bhitari Pillar Inscription** in Ghazipur district records Emperor **Skandagupta's** crushing defeat of the invading Hunas.
9. **Dashavatara Temple at Deogarh (Lalitpur)** is one of the earliest surviving Gupta stone panchayatana temples.
10. **Bhitargaon Temple in Kanpur** is the oldest surviving terraced brick temple with a shikhara and true arches in India.
11. **Kannauj** was the imperial capital of Emperor **Harshavardhana** and the prize of the 8th–10th century **Tripartite Struggle**.
12. **Agra** was founded by Sultan **Sikandar Lodi in 1504**, who shifted the Sultanate capital there in **1506**.
13. **Jaunpur** was founded by **Feroz Shah Tughlaq in 1359** in memory of Muhammad bin Tughlaq (Jauna Khan) and nicknamed **"Shiraz-e-Hind"**.
14. The magnificent **Atala Masjid** in Jaunpur was built in **1408** by **Ibrahim Shah Sharqi**.
15. **Akbar** established his ceremonial capital at **Fatehpur Sikri** in honour of Sufi Saint **Sheikh Salim Chishti**.
16. The **Buland Darwaza** at Fatehpur Sikri (54m high) was built by Akbar to celebrate his victory over **Gujarat**.
17. **Itimad-ud-Daulah's Tomb in Agra**, built by Empress Nur Jahan, was the first Mughal building made completely of white marble with **Pietra Dura** inlay.
18. **Taj Mahal** was designed by chief architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori** and completed in 1648 on the banks of the Yamuna.
19. The Nawabi dynasty of Awadh was established in **1722 by Saadat Khan (Burhan-ul-Mulk)**.
20. Nawab **Asaf-ud-Daula shifted the capital of Awadh from Faizabad to Lucknow in 1775**.
21. Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula constructed the **Bara Imambara** (with its famous Bhul-bhulaiya) and **Rumi Darwaza** in 1784 as famine relief projects.
22. Awadh was annexed by Lord Dalhousie on **13 February 1856** on grounds of alleged **"misgovernance"** (James Outram Report).
23. The **Revolt of 1857** erupted in Uttar Pradesh on **10 May 1857 at Meerut** when the 3rd Native Cavalry mutinied.
24. **Begum Hazrat Mahal** led the 1857 resistance in Lucknow, crowning her minor son **Birjis Qadr** as Nawab.
25. **Nana Sahib (Dhondu Pant)** and **Tantia Tope** led the 1857 rebellion at **Kanpur (Bithoor)**.
26. **Rani Lakshmibai (Manikarnika)** was martyred fighting British forces under General Hugh Rose at Gwalior in June 1858.
27. **Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah**, who spearheaded the resistance in Faizabad, was hailed as the "Lighthouse of Rebellion".
28. **Khan Bahadur Khan** established a parallel administration during the 1857 Revolt in **Bareilly (Rohilkhand)**.
29. **Maulvi Liaquat Ali** led the 1857 uprising in **Prayagraj (Allahabad)** from Khusro Bagh.

30. Queen Victoria's **Proclamation of 1858** was read out by Lord Canning on **1 November 1858 at Minto Park, Allahabad**.
31. A total of **9 Annual Sessions** of the Indian National Congress were hosted in Uttar Pradesh prior to 1947.
32. **Sarojini Naidu** became the **First Indian Woman President** of the Indian National Congress at the **Kanpur Session (1925)**.
33. The historic **Lucknow Session of INC (1916)** presided by **A.C. Mazumdar** saw the signing of the **Lucknow Pact**.
34. The **UP Kisan Sabha** was founded in **February 1918** by Gauri Shankar Mishra, Indra Narain Dwivedi, and Madan Mohan Malaviya.
35. The **Oudh Kisan Sabha** was established in **October 1920 at Pratapgarh** under the leadership of **Baba Ramchandra**.
36. The **Eka Movement (1921–22)** was a radical peasant uprising in Hardoi, Bahraich, and Sitapur led by **Madari Pasi**.
37. The **Chauri Chaura incident** occurred on **4 February 1922** in Gorakhpur, leading Mahatma Gandhi to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement on **12 February 1922**.
38. The **Kakori Train Action** was carried out on **9 August 1925** near Lucknow by revolutionaries of the HRA.
39. **Ram Prasad Bismil** was martyred at **Gorakhpur Jail**, **Ashfaqulla Khan** at **Faizabad Jail**, **Roshan Singh** at **Naini (Prayagraj) Jail**, and **Rajendra Lahiri** at **Gonda Jail** in Dec 1927.
40. **Chandrashekhar Azad** attained martyrdom fighting British police at **Alfred Park, Prayagraj on 27 February 1931**.
41. **Chittu Pandey ("Sher-e-Ballia")** established the first **Parallel Government** (*Swaraj Sarkar*) at Ballia during the Quit India Movement in August 1942.
42. **Charkula Dance** is a traditional folk dance of the **Braj (Mathura) region** where women balance a wooden pyramid with **108 lit lamps**.
43. **Rai Dance** is a peacock folk dance performed by the Beriya community of **Bundelkhand**.
44. **Karma Dance** is a sacred tribal folk dance performed in **Sonbhadra and Mirzapur** districts.
45. **Alha** is the famous heroic ballad of Bundelkhand recounting the battles of **Alha and Udal** in Banaffari dialect.
46. **Kajri** is the semi-classical monsoon folk song originating from **Mirzapur and Varanasi**.
47. **Birha** is the narrative folk singing tradition popular among the Yadav/Ahir community of **Purvanchal (Eastern UP)**.
48. **Bateshwar Fair (Agra)** is the largest livestock and camel fair in Western UP, held on the banks of Yamuna.
49. **Dadri Fair (Ballia)**, held on Kartik Purnima in honour of Maharishi Bhrigu, is the 2nd largest cattle fair in India.
50. **Kumbh Mela (Prayagraj)** was inscribed on the **UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage List in 2017**, and **Ramnagar Ramlila** in **2008**.

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: Ancient & Medieval Historical Sites, Dynasties and Monuments in Uttar Pradesh

Historical Site / Monument	Location / District	Associated Dynasty / Ruler	Era / Century	Key Historical & Archaeological Significance
Sohgaura Copper Plate	**Gorakhpur**	Mauryan Empire (Chandragupta Maurya / Ashoka)	3rd Century BCE	Oldest known copper-plate inscription in India; mentions state granaries and drought relief measures in Brahmi script.
Sarnath (Isipatana / Mrigadava)	**Varanasi**	Mauryan to Gupta	6th Century BCE – 5th Century CE	Site of Lord Buddha's **First Sermon (Dharmachakrapravartana)**. Features Ashoka's Lion Capital (National Emblem) and Dhamek Stupa.

Historical Site / Monument	Location / District	Associated Dynasty / Ruler	Era / Century	Key Historical & Archaeological Significance
Shravasti (Sahet-Mahet)	**Shravasti / Balrampur**	Kosala Kingdom (Prasenjit)	6th Century BCE	Capital of Kosala; site where Lord Buddha spent maximum rainy season retreats (**25 Varshavas**) and performed Jetavana miracles.
Kushinagar (Kasia)	**Kushinagar**	Malla Mahajanapada	483 BCE	Site of Lord Buddha's **Mahaparinirvana** (death/salvation). Features Parinirvana Temple (Reclining Buddha) and Ramabhar Stupa.
Piprahwa / Ganwaria	**Siddharthnagar**	Shakya Republic	5th–3rd Century BCE	Identified with ancient **Kapilavastu**; stupa excavated with caskets containing Buddha's bodily relics.
Kaushambi	**Kaushambi** (near Prayagraj)	Vatsa Mahajanapada (King Udayana)	6th Century BCE	Capital of Vatsa; important commercial and Buddhist centre (Ghoshitarama Monastery). Visited by Hieun Tsang.
Bhitari Pillar Inscription	**Saidpur, Ghazipur**	Gupta Empire (Skandagupta)	5th Century CE (455–467 CE)	Details Skandagupta's decisive victory over the invading White Hunas and Pushyamitras.
Dashavatara Temple	**Deogarh, Lalitpur**	Imperial Gupta Dynasty	6th Century CE	One of the earliest surviving stone panchayatana Hindu temples; famous for Vishnu Sheshashayi panel.
Bhitargaon Brick Temple	**Kanpur Nagar**	Imperial Gupta Dynasty	5th–6th Century CE	Oldest surviving terraced brick temple with a shikhara and arched doorways in northern India.
Kannauj (Kanyakubja)	**Kannauj**	Harshavardhana / Gurjara-Pratiharas	7th–10th Century CE	Capital of Emperor Harsha; epicentre of the **Tripartite Struggle** (Pratiharas, Palas, Rashtrakutas). "Mahodaya Shri".
Atala Masjid	**Jaunpur**	Sharqi Dynasty (Ibrahim Shah Sharqi)	1408 CE	Masterpiece of Jaunpur Sharqi architecture; built on the site of Atala Devi temple, featuring sloping walls and high propylons.
Agra Fort	**Agra**	Mughal Empire (Akbar)	1565–1573 CE	Red sandstone fortress and primary residence of Mughal emperors until 1648. UNESCO World Heritage Site (1983).
Fatehpur Sikri	**Agra District**	Mughal Empire (Akbar)	1571–1585 CE	Akbar's ceremonial capital built in honour of Sufi Saint Sheikh Salim Chishti; features **Buland Darwaza**, Panch Mahal, and Jodha Bai's Palace.
Bara Imambara (Asafi Imambara)	**Lucknow**	Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula	1784 CE	Built as a famine-relief project; famous for its unsupported central vaulted hall and the intricate labyrinth (**Bhul-bhulaiya**).
Rumi Darwaza	**Lucknow**	Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula	1784 CE	60-foot tall monumental entrance gateway to Lucknow modeled on the Sublime Porte in Constantinople (Istanbul).

Table 2: 1857 Revolt Centres, Revolutionary Actions and Freedom Struggle in Uttar Pradesh

Event / Movement	Primary Location	Key Indian Leaders	British Commanders / Officials	Historical Significance & Turning Points
Spark of 1857 Revolt	**Meerut**	Sepoys of 3rd Native Cavalry, Kotwal Dhan Singh Gurjar	Gen. Hewitt	On **10 May 1857**, sepoys broke into open mutiny, killed British officers, and marched to Delhi to crown Bahadur Shah Zafar.

Event / Movement	Primary Location	Key Indian Leaders	British Commanders / Officials	Historical Significance & Turning Points
Lucknow Resistance (1857)	**Lucknow (Residency)**	**Begum Hazrat Mahal**, Birjis Qadr, Maulvi Ahmadullah	Sir Henry Lawrence (died), Colin Campbell, Outram	Heroic siege of the Lucknow Residency; Begum Hazrat Mahal crowned her 11-year-old son Birjis Qadr as Nawab; later escaped to Nepal.
Kanpur Uprising (1857)	**Kanpur (Bithoor)**	**Nana Sahib (Dhondu Pant)**, **Tantia Tope**, Azimullah Khan	Sir Hugh Wheeler, Colin Campbell, Havelock	Nana Sahib declared Peshwa; Bibighar incident; Tantia Tope led guerrilla warfare across Bundelkhand.
Jhansi & Kalpi (1857)	**Jhansi / Kalpi**	**Rani Lakshmibai (Manikarnika)**	Sir Hugh Rose	Rani resisted annexation under Doctrine of Lapse; fought valiantly at Jhansi and Gwalior where she attained martyrdom in June 1858.
Allahabad (1857)	**Prayagraj (Allahabad)**	**Maulvi Liaquat Ali**	Colonel James Neill	Maulvi Liaquat Ali proclaimed independence from Khusro Bagh; brutal British retribution followed under Neill.
Faizabad / Awadh (1857)	**Faizabad / Ayodhya**	**Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah** ("Lighthouse of Rebellion")	Colin Campbell	Fiery leader of anti-British resistance who gave immense tactical trouble to British forces; killed at Powayan.
Bareilly / Rohilkhand (1857)	**Bareilly**	**Khan Bahadur Khan** (grandson of Hafiz Rahmat Khan)	Colin Campbell	Formed parallel administrative government in Rohilkhand; maintained order for nearly a year.
Allahabad Proclamation	**Minto Park, Prayagraj**	Lord Canning (First Viceroy)	Queen Victoria	**1 November 1858**: Queen Victoria's Proclamation read out, terminating East India Company rule and establishing direct British Crown rule.
UP Kisan Sabha	**Prayagraj / Awadh**	Gauri Shankar Mishra, Indra Narain Dwivedi, Madan Mohan Malaviya	Formed Feb 1918	Mobilized peasants against talukdari oppressions and illegal cesses (*nazarana*, *bedakhli*).
Oudh Kisan Sabha	**Pratapgarh**	**Baba Ramchandra**, Jawaharlal Nehru, Mata Badal Pande	Formed Oct 1920	Peasant mobilization in Pratapgarh, Rae Bareli, Sultanpur; demanded abolishing begar and illegal eviction.
Eka Movement (1921–22)	**Hardoi, Bahraich, Sitapur**	**Madari Pasi**, Sahadev	Suppressed 1922	Radical peasant movement taking religious oaths not to pay more than recorded rents and refusal of forced labour.
Chauri Chaura Incident	**Gorakhpur**	Bhagwan Ahir & peasant protesters	Police Chowki torched	**4 February 1922**: Violent clash leading to death of 22 policemen; prompted Mahatma Gandhi to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement on **12 February 1922**.

Event / Movement	Primary Location	Key Indian Leaders	British Commanders / Officials	Historical Significance & Turning Points
Kakori Train Action	**Kakori (near Lucknow)**	**Ram Prasad Bismil**, **Ashfaqulla Khan**, Roshan Singh, Rajendra Lahiri, Chandrashekhar Azad	HRA (Hindustan Republican Assoc.)	**9 August 1925**: HRA revolutionaries looted British government treasury from 8-Down train. 4 leaders hanged in Dec 1927 in 4 distinct UP jails.
Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)	**Feroz Shah Kotla (founded), active across UP (Kanpur/Agra/Prayagraj)**	Chandrashekhar Azad, Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev	British CID	Reorganized HRA into HSRA in Sept 1928 with a commitment to socialism. Azad martyred at **Alfred Park (Prayagraj)** on **27 Feb 1931**.
Ballia Parallel Government	**Ballia**	**Chittu Pandey** ("Sher-e-Ballia")	Quit India Movement (Aug 1942)	Set up the first independent parallel government (*Swaraj Sarkar*) during Quit India Movement; released all political prisoners.

Table 3: Culture, Music Gharanas, Folk Dances, Fairs, Festivals & Traditional Crafts

Cultural Genre	Name / Style	Core District / Cultural Zone	Primary Maestros / Exponents / Originators	Distinguishing Characteristics & Features
Classical Dance	**Kathak (Lucknow Gharana)**	**Lucknow**	Ishwari Prasad, Thakur Prasad, Bindadin Maharaj, Kalka Prasad, Achhan Maharaj, **Birju Maharaj**	Emphasizes graceful *Bhav*, subtle facial expressions, delicate hand movements (*Gat Nikas*), and *Thumri* accompaniment; patronized by Nawab Wajid Ali Shah.
Vocal / Instrumental Gharana	**Kirana Gharana**	**Kirana (Shamli / Muzaffarnagar)**	Ustad Abdul Karim Khan, Ustad Abdul Wahid Khan, **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi**, Gangubai Hangal	Renowned for emotional depth, meticulous swara intonation, slow tempo (*Vilambit Khayal*), and mastery over Sarangi/Vocal notes.
Vocal / Instrumental Gharana	**Banaras Gharana**	**Varanasi**	**Ustad Bismillah Khan** (Shehnai), **Pt. Kishan Maharaj** (Tabla), Pt. Samta Prasad, **Girija Devi** (Thumri/Dadra), Rajan-Sajan Mishra	Renowned for soulful Thumri, Dadra, Chaiti, Kajri, bold resonant Tabla bols (*Banaras Baaj*), and world-renowned Shehnai recitals.
Vocal Gharana	**Agra Gharana (Rangeela Gharana)**	**Agra**	Haji Sujan Khan, Ustad Ghagghe Khuda Baksh, **Ustad Faiyaz Khan** (Rangeela)	Blend of Dhrupad-Dhamar and Khayal; characterized by powerful deep voice, Nom-Tom alap, and bol-taans.
Folk Dance	**Charkula**	**Braj Region (Mathura)**	Braj women dancers	Performed on Radha's birthday; dancers balance a heavy multi-tiered wooden pyramid with **108 lit oil lamps** on their head while dancing on wheels.
Folk Dance	**Rai Dance**	**Bundelkhand**	Beriya community women	Vibrant peacock dance performed on auspicious occasions (birth of son, festivals) to the rapid beat of *Mridang*.
Folk Dance	**Karma Dance**	**Sonbhadra & Mirzapur**	Kharwar, Kol, Baiga, and Gond tribes	Performed during Karma festival (autumn) around the sacred Karma tree invoking agricultural fertility and prosperity.

Cultural Genre	Name / Style	Core District / Cultural Zone	Primary Maestros / Exponents / Originators	Distinguishing Characteristics & Features
Folk Dance	**Pai Danda (Dandia)**	**Bundelkhand**	Ahir / Yadav community	Heroic stick dance resembling Gujarati Dandiya; performed during Diwali enacting Krishna's pastoral life.
Folk Song	**Alha**	**Bundelkhand (Mahoba / Jhansi)**	Traditional Alhets	Heroic narrative ballads in *Banaffari* dialect recounting 52 fierce battles of warrior brothers Alha and Udal.
Folk Song	**Kajri**	**Mirzapur & Varanasi**	Purvanchal singers	Semi-classical rainy-season (Shravan/Bhadon) song expressing romantic longing, separation, and Radha-Krishna devotion.
Folk Song	**Birha**	**Purvanchal (Eastern UP)**	Ahir / Yadav community	Narrative folk genre chronicling social events, historical ballads, and mythological episodes with high-pitched vocal delivery.
Folk Theatre	**Nautanki**	**Hathras & Kanpur**	Hathras School (Pt. Natharam Gaur), Kanpur School (Shrikrishna Pahalwan)	**Hathras style**: Classical, verse-dominated, high melody (*Doha, Chaubola*). **Kanpur style**: Theatrical, prose dialogues, social dramas.
Major Fair	**Bateshwar Fair**	**Bateshwar (Agra)**	On banks of Yamuna	Ancient holy pilgrimage (101 Shiva temples) and the **largest animal/camel/cattle fair** in Western UP (Kartik Purnima).
Major Fair	**Dadri Fair**	**Ballia**	Dedicated to Sage Bhrigu	**Second largest cattle fair in India** (after Sonepur); held annually on Kartik Purnima.
Major Fair	**Nauchandi Fair**	**Meerut**	Symbol of communal harmony	Month-long post-Holi fair celebrating both Navchandi Devi Temple and Saint Bale Miyan Dargah.
Major Fair	**Dewa Sharif Fair**	**Dewa (Barabanki)**	Dargah of Haji Waris Ali Shah	Celebrated during Safar/Kartik; promotes universal brotherhood (*Jo Rab Hai Wahi Ram Hai*).

One-Liner Revision – UP History and Culture

#	Fast Fact
1	8 of 16 Mahajanapadas located in UP
2	Buddha's First Sermon = **Dharmachakrapravartana** at **Sarnath**
3	Buddha's death = **Kushinagar (483 BCE)**
4	Prayag Prashasti composer = **Harishena** (Samudragupta's court poet)
5	Taj Mahal architect = **Ustad Ahmad Lahori**
6	Taj Mahal UNESCO = **1983**; Fatehpur Sikri = **1986**
7	Kumbh Mela UNESCO ICH = **2017**
8	Ramnagar Ramlila UNESCO ICH = **2008**
9	Meerut 1857 uprising = **10 May 1857**
10	Begum Hazrat Mahal crowned **Birjis Qadr** as Nawab of Lucknow

#	Fast Fact
11	Kakori Train Action = **9 August 1925**
12	Ram Prasad Bismil hanged = **Gorakhpur Jail**
13	Ashfaqulla Khan hanged = **Faizabad Jail**
14	Chandrashekhar Azad martyrdom = **Alfred Park, Prayagraj, 27 Feb 1931**
15	Chauri Chaura = **4 Feb 1922** (NCM withdrawn 12 Feb)
16	Eka Movement (1921-22) = **Madari Pasi** (Hardoi, Bahraich)
17	First Parallel Government (1942) = **Chittu Pandey**, Ballia
18	Kathak = UP classical dance; Lucknow and Jaipur Gharanas
19	Pandit Birju Maharaj = Lucknow **Kalka-Bindadin Gharana**
20	Girija Devi = “Queen of Thumri” – **Banaras Gharana**

Topic 3 — Polity, Administration and Local Government

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. Uttar Pradesh has the largest **Legislative Assembly (Vidhan Sabha)** in India with **403 elected members**.
2. Prior to the creation of Uttarakhand on 9 November 2000, the UP Legislative Assembly had **425 seats**.
3. The **UP Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad)** has **100 seats**, the largest Upper House among Indian states.
4. Uttar Pradesh is represented by **80 Lok Sabha Members** and **31 Rajya Sabha Members**, the highest for any state.
5. In the Lok Sabha, **17 seats** are reserved for Scheduled Castes (SC) and **0 seats** for Scheduled Tribes (ST) from UP.
6. In the UP Legislative Assembly, **84 seats** are reserved for SCs and **2 seats** (Obra and Duddhi) for STs.
7. Under the 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003), the Council of Ministers in UP is capped at **60 ministers** (15% of 403).
8. The value of an MLA's vote from Uttar Pradesh in the Presidential Election is **208**, the highest among all Indian states.
9. **Smt. Sarojini Naidu** was the **First Woman Governor** of Uttar Pradesh and the first woman Governor in India (1947–1949).
10. **Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant** was the **First Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh (1950–1954).
11. **Smt. Sucheta Kripalani** became the **First Woman Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh and India in October 1963.
12. **Chaudhary Charan Singh** served as the first non-Congress Chief Minister of UP (1967) and later became Prime Minister of India.
13. The **High Court of Judicature at Allahabad** was established on **17 March 1866** at Agra before moving to Allahabad in **1869**.
14. The **Lucknow Bench** of the Allahabad High Court was created in **1948** by amalgamating the Chief Court of Oudh.
15. The Allahabad High Court has a sanctioned strength of **160 Judges**, making it the largest High Court in India.
16. The **first Chief Justice** of Allahabad High Court was **Sir Walter Morgan** (1866).
17. The first Indian Chief Justice of Allahabad High Court post-independence was **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik**.
18. Uttar Pradesh is administratively divided into **18 Divisions (Mandals)** and **75 Districts (Zilas)**.
19. The headquarters of **Devipatan Division** is located at **Gonda**.
20. The headquarters of **Chitrakoot Division** is located at **Banda**.
21. The largest administrative divisions by number of districts (6 districts each) are **Lucknow, Kanpur, and Meerut**.
22. **Hapur** is the smallest district of UP by geographic area (660 km^2), while **Lakhimpur Kheri** is the largest (7,680 km^2).
23. The **Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission (UPPSC)** was established on **1 April 1937** with its headquarters at **Prayagraj**.
24. Members of UPPSC are appointed by the **Governor**, but can only be removed by the **President of India** (Article 317).
25. The functions of UPPSC can be extended exclusively by the **UP State Legislature** under Article 321 of the Constitution.
26. The **State Election Commission of UP** was established on **23 April 1994** under Articles 243K and 243ZA to conduct local elections.
27. The State Election Commissioner is removed in the same manner and on like grounds as a **Judge of a High Court**.
28. The **State Finance Commission** in UP is constituted every 5 years by the **Governor** under Articles 243I and 243Y.
29. The **UP Lokayukta and Up-Lokayuktas Act** was passed in **1975**, and the first Lokayukta **Justice Vishwambhar Dayal** was appointed in 1977.

30. The tenure of the UP Lokayukta was extended from 6 years to **8 years** by an amendment in 2012.
31. The base statute for rural local self-government in UP is the **UP Panchayat Raj Act, 1947**.
32. Intermediate and district rural bodies operate under the **UP Kshettra Panchayats and Zila Panchayats Act, 1961**.
33. There are **75 Zila Panchayats**, **826 Kshetra Panchayats**, and **~58,189 Gram Panchayats** in Uttar Pradesh.
34. The intermediate tier of Panchayati Raj in Uttar Pradesh is officially designated as **Kshetra Panchayat** (headed by Block Pramukh).
35. The political head of a Gram Panchayat is the **Gram Pradhan**, directly elected by the Gram Sabha.
36. The **Gram Sabha** consists of all persons registered in the electoral rolls of a village within the Panchayat area.
37. Uttar Pradesh provides **50% reservation for women** in Panchayati Raj Institutions and Urban Local Bodies by state statute.
38. The minimum age required to contest elections for Gram Panchayat, Kshetra Panchayat, or Zila Panchayat is **21 years**.
39. Uttar Pradesh has **17 Nagar Nigams (Municipal Corporations)**.
40. The 17th and newest Nagar Nigam created in Uttar Pradesh is **Shahjahanpur**.
41. The political head of a Nagar Nigam is the **Mayor (Mahapaur)**, directly elected by the city electorate.
42. The executive and administrative head of a Nagar Nigam is the **Municipal Commissioner (Nagar Ayukt)**, an IAS officer.
43. **NOIDA, Greater Noida, and YEIDA** are not Nagar Nigams; they are **Industrial Townships** constituted under Article 243Q proviso.
44. The official language of Uttar Pradesh is **Hindi in Devanagari script** (declared in 1951).
45. **Urdu** was declared the **Second Official Language** of Uttar Pradesh in **1989** through an amendment to the UP Official Language Act.
46. The state statehood day of Uttar Pradesh (**UP Diwas**) is celebrated annually on **24 January** (commemorating the 1950 notification).
47. **President's Rule (Article 356)** has been imposed in Uttar Pradesh a total of **10 times** (first in 1968, last in 2002).
48. The Secretariat of the Government of Uttar Pradesh is located at **Vidhan Bhavan / Sachivalaya, Lucknow**.
49. The head of the administrative hierarchy and civil services in Uttar Pradesh is the **Chief Secretary**.
50. Uttar Pradesh has **no Scheduled Areas** under the Fifth Schedule of the Constitution; therefore, the **PESA Act, 1996 does not apply** in UP.

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: Constitutional Structure, Legislature and Parliamentary Representation of Uttar Pradesh

Constitutional Organ / House	Total Strength / Seat Count	Constitutional Provision / Term / Quorum	Composition & Election Mode	Key Specifics & Powers
Uttar Pradesh Legislative Assembly (Vidhan Sabha)	**403 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Article 170** • Term: 5 Years • Minimum Age: **25 Years** • Quorum: 10 or 1/10th (41)	Direct universal adult franchise from single-member constituencies across 75 districts.	• **Reserved Seats**: **84 SC**, **2 ST** (total 86 reserved seats). • Exclusive power over Money Bills (Art. 198). • Council of Ministers is collectively responsible solely to the Vidhan Sabha. • Pre-Uttarakhand strength was **425 seats**.

Constitutional Organ / House	Total Strength / Seat Count	Constitutional Provision / Term / Quorum	Composition & Election Mode	Key Specifics & Powers
Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad)	**100 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Articles 169 & 171** • Permanent House (Cannot be dissolved) • Term: 6 Years (1/3rd retire every 2 years) • Minimum Age: **30 Years**	• **36 Members**: Elected by Local Authorities constituencies. • **36 Members**: Elected by MLAs (Vidhan Sabha). • **10 Members**: Nominated by Governor (Literature, Science, Art, Co-operative movement, Social service). • **9 Members**: Elected by Graduates constituencies. • **9 Members**: Elected by Teachers constituencies. *(Statutory composition totaling 100)*	• Maximum constitutional ceiling = 1/3rd of Assembly (134 seats); UP chose 100. • Can delay an ordinary bill passed by Assembly for a maximum of 4 months (3 months + 1 month), but cannot veto it. • No power over Money Bills (can delay max 14 days).
Lok Sabha Representation from UP	**80 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Article 81** • Term: 5 Years • Minimum Age: 25 Years	Direct election by the people of Uttar Pradesh.	• **Reserved Seats**: **17 SC Seats**, **0 ST Seats**. • Constitutes ~14.7% of the total Lok Sabha strength (543 seats). • Pre-Uttarakhand strength was **85 seats**.
Rajya Sabha Representation from UP	**31 Seats** (Largest in India)	**Article 80** • Term: 6 Years (1/3rd retire every 2 years) • Minimum Age: 30 Years	Proportional representation by single transferable vote (STV) by 403 elected MLAs of UP.	• Largest contingent in the Council of States. • Governor does NOT nominate members to Rajya Sabha. • Pre-Uttarakhand strength was **34 seats**.
State Executive (Governor & Council of Ministers)	Council of Ministers capped at **15% of 403 = Max 60 Ministers**	**Articles 153 to 167** • Governor appointed by President (Art. 155) • 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003)	Council of Ministers headed by Chief Minister aids and advises the Governor.	• First Governor: **Sarojini Naidu** (15 Aug 1947 – 2 Mar 1949). • First Chief Minister: **Govind Ballabh Pant** (1950–1954). • First Woman CM: **Sucheta Kripalani** (1963–1967). • Value of UP MLA vote in Presidential Election is highest in India (**208**).

Table 2: Judiciary, Constitutional & Statutory Commissions of Uttar Pradesh

Institution / Commission	Established Year / Legal Basis	Headquarters / Bench	Composition & Appointment Authority	Mandate, Removal & Key Characteristics
Allahabad High Court	**17 March 1866** (Letters Patent under High Courts Act 1861); moved from Agra to Allahabad in **1869**	**Prayagraj (Principal Seat)**; Permanent Bench at **Lucknow** (est. 1948)	• Chief Justice + Judges (Total Sanctioned Strength: **160 Judges** — Largest in India). • Appointed by the President of India (Art. 217).	• Highest court of appeal in UP. • First Chief Justice at Agra: **Sir Walter Morgan**. • First Indian Chief Justice: **Sir Shah Muhammad Sulaiman** (acting) / **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik** (post-1947). • Lucknow Bench created by amalgamating the Chief Court of Oudh (1925) via the UP High Courts (Amalgamation) Order, 1948.

Institution / Commission	Established Year / Legal Basis	Headquarters / Bench	Composition & Appointment Authority	Mandate, Removal & Key Characteristics
Uttar Pradesh Public Service Commission (UPPSC)	**1 April 1937** (under GoI Act 1935 / Arts. 315–323 of Constitution)	**Prayagraj (Allahabad)**	• Chairman + Members (up to 8 members). • Appointed by the **Governor** of UP. • Tenure: 6 Years or Age **62 Years**, whichever is earlier.	• Conducts state civil services examinations (Combined State / Upper Subordinate, RO/ARO, etc.). • **Removal**: Can be removed **ONLY by the President of India** on grounds of misbehaviour after inquiry by the Supreme Court (Art. 317). • Functions extended exclusively by the **UP State Legislature** (Art. 321).
State Election Commission (SEC)	**23 April 1994** (under Articles **243K & 243ZA**)	**Lucknow**	• Single State Election Commissioner. • Appointed by the **Governor**.	• Conducts and superintends all elections to **Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs)** and **Urban Local Bodies (ULBs)** in UP. • **Removal**: Removed in like manner and on like grounds as a **Judge of a High Court**. • Does NOT conduct Assembly or Parliamentary elections (handled by ECI).
State Finance Commission (SFC)	Constituted every 5 years under Articles **243I & 243Y**	**Lucknow**	• Chairman + Members appointed by the **Governor**.	• Recommends principles governing devolution of state taxes/duties to Panchayats and Municipalities, and measures to augment the Consolidated Fund of the State.
Lokayukta & Up-Lokayukta	**UP Lokayukta and Up-Lokayuktas Act, 1975** (Enacted 1975, took effect 1977)	**Lucknow**	• Lokayukta appointed by Governor in consultation with Chief Justice of Allahabad HC and Leader of Opposition. • Tenure: Extended to **8 Years** (UP Act No. 4 of 2012).	• Investigates allegations of corruption and maladministration against public servants, Ministers, and MLAs. • First Lokayukta of UP: **Justice Vishwambhar Dayal** (appointed Sept 1977).

Table 3: Administrative Hierarchy & Local Self-Government Framework

Administrative Tier	Executive Head / Political Head	Statutory / Administrative Basis	Total Units in UP	Key Functions & Responsibilities
Administrative Division (Mandal)	**Divisional Commissioner (IAS)**	Land Revenue / Administrative Setup	**18 Divisions**	• Coordinates inter-district administration, revenue appeals, law and order, and state developmental schemes across 3 to 6 districts. • Largest divisions: Lucknow, Kanpur, Meerut (6 districts each).
District (Zila)	**District Magistrate / Collector (DM / DC)**	Code of Criminal Procedure / Land Revenue Acts	**75 Districts**	• Principal representative of State Government; heads revenue collection, law & order, disaster management, and district coordination.
Sub-Division / Tehsil	**Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM) / Tehsildar**	UP Revenue Code 2006	**351 Tehsils**	• Sub-divisional administration, revenue courts, land mutation, issuance of caste/income/domicile certificates.
Development Block (Vikas Khand)	**Block Development Officer (BDO)**	Community Development Administration	**826 Blocks**	• Unit of rural developmental administration; executes MNREGA, rural housing, sanitation, and agricultural extension.

Administrative Tier	Executive Head / Political Head	Statutory / Administrative Basis	Total Units in UP	Key Functions & Responsibilities
Zila Panchayat (District Tier)	**Zila Panchayat Adhyaksha** (Political); **Apar Mukhya Adhikari / CDO** (Executive)	UP Kshettra Panchayats and Zila Panchayats Act, 1961	**75 Zila Panchayats**	• Apex rural local self-government tier; prepares district annual development plan, maintains rural roads, inter-block infrastructure.
Kshetra Panchayat (Block Tier)	**Block Pramukh** (Political); **Block Development Officer (BDO)** (Executive)	UP Kshettra Panchayats and Zila Panchayats Act, 1961	**826 Kshetra Panchayats**	• Intermediate rural local tier; coordinates village plans, manages community assets, minor irrigation, public health.
Gram Panchayat (Village Tier)	**Gram Pradhan** (Political); **Gram Panchayat Adhikari / Secretary** (Executive)	UP Panchayat Raj Act, 1947	**~58,189 Gram Panchayats**	• Base rural self-governance unit; accountable to **Gram Sabha** (all registered voters); 50% reservation for women in UP.
Nagar Nigam (Municipal Corporation)	**Mayor (Mahapaur)** (Political); **Municipal Commissioner (Nagar Ayukt - IAS)** (Executive)	UP Municipal Corporation Act, 1959	**17 Municipal Corporations**	• Urban local bodies for large metropolitan cities (Lucknow, Kanpur, Prayagraj, Varanasi, Agra, Ghaziabad, Meerut, Bareilly, Aligarh, Moradabad, Gorakhpur, Jhansi, Saharanpur, Firozabad, Ayodhya, Mathura-Vrindavan, Shahjahanpur).
Industrial Townships (Exception under Art. 243Q)	**Chief Executive Officer (CEO - IAS)**	UP Industrial Area Development Act, 1976	**NOIDA, Greater Noida, YEIDA**	• Governed by statutory industrial authorities providing civic amenities; exempt from forming elected Municipal Corporations under the proviso to Art. 243Q.

One-Liner Revision – UP Polity

#	Fast Fact
1	UP Vidhan Sabha = **403 seats** (largest State legislature in India)
2	UP Vidhan Parishad = **100 seats**
3	UP Lok Sabha seats = **80** (largest State delegation)
4	UP Rajya Sabha seats = **31**
5	UP State governed by **UP Panchayati Raj Act, 1947**
6	Gram Panchayat head = **Pradhan** (प्रधान)
7	Kshetra Panchayat head = **Pramukh** (प्रमुख)
8	Zila Panchayat head = **Adhyaksha** (अध्यक्ष)
9	UP Nagar Nigams = **17** (2023)
10	UP has 75 districts (largest number of districts in any State)
11	UP State capital = **Lucknow**
12	UP HC = **Allahabad High Court** (Prayagraj) – largest HC by judges
13	Allahabad HC established = **1866**

#	Fast Fact
14	UP Governor appointed by **President of India**
15	Women reservation in UP Panchayats = **50%** (increased in 2020)

Topic 4 — Economy, Industry and Infrastructure

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. Uttar Pradesh is the **3rd largest state economy** in India by nominal Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP).
2. The Government of UP has set a formal strategic target to achieve a **1 Trillion Economy**.
3. The **Tertiary (Services) sector** is the largest contributor to UP's GSDP, accounting for nearly **48%–50%**.
4. The **Primary (Agriculture) sector** employs roughly **45%–50%** of Uttar Pradesh's working population.
5. India's first modern sugar mill was established in **1903 at Pratappur in Deoria district**.
6. Uttar Pradesh is the **largest producer of sugarcane** in India.
7. **Muzaffarnagar** hosts the largest jaggery (*Gud*) market in Asia.
8. **Kanpur** was historically renowned as the **"Manchester of the East"** and the **"Leather City of the World"**.
9. **Agra** accounts for approximately **28% of total Indian footwear exports**.
10. **Moradabad** is known as **"Peetal Nagari" (Brass City)**, accounting for over 40% of India's metal handicraft exports.
11. **Firozabad** is famous as **"Suhag Nagari"** and holds a virtual monopoly in glass bangles manufacturing.
12. **Aligarh** is internationally famous as the **"City of Locks" (Taala Nagari)**.
13. **Bhadohi** is officially recognized as the **"Carpet City"**, producing over half of India's exported handmade carpets.
14. The **Indian Institute of Carpet Technology (IICT)** is located at **Bhadohi**.
15. **Kannauj** is known as the **"Attar Nagari"** (Perfume City) or the "Grasse of the East" for traditional *Deg-Bhapka* attar distillation.
16. The **Fragrance and Flavour Development Centre (FFDC)** is located at **Kannauj**.
17. **Sonbhadra** is celebrated as the **"Energy Capital of India"** due to its immense pithead thermal power complexes.
18. **Renukoot (Sonbhadra)** is the site of **HINDALCO**, one of Asia's largest integrated aluminium smelting plants.
19. The **HINDALCO** plant at Renukoot draws hydro-electric power from the **Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)**.
20. **Singrauli (Sonbhadra)** is the only region in Uttar Pradesh with commercial **coal mining** deposits.
21. **Khurja (Bulandshahr)** is world-famous as the **"Ceramic City"** for glazed pottery and electrical porcelain insulators.
22. **Saharanpur** is internationally renowned for delicate **carved wooden handicrafts** in Sheesham wood.
23. **Nizamabad (Azamgarh)** is famous for its unique GI-tagged **Black Clay Pottery**.
24. **Gorakhpur** is renowned for its GI-tagged traditional terracotta horses, elephants, and clay artifacts.
25. **Lalitpur** is the **only district in Uttar Pradesh** where traces of **Uranium** have been discovered.
26. **Copper** mineralization in UP is concentrated in the **Sonrai area of Lalitpur district**.
27. **Shankargarh (Prayagraj)** is the premier hub for high-grade **Silica Sand (Glass Sand)** extraction.
28. UP is the leading producer of **Diaspore and Pyrophyllite** minerals in India (Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba).
29. **Kajrahat (Sonbhadra)** and **Bhalua (Mirzapur)** are major sources of high-grade **Limestone** for cement factories.
30. The **Narora Atomic Power Station (NAPS)** in **Bulandshahr** is the **only nuclear power plant** in Uttar Pradesh.
31. The oldest thermal power plant in Uttar Pradesh is the **Harduaganj Thermal Power Station (Aligarh)**, set up in **1942**.
32. The **Mathura Oil Refinery (IOCL)**, commissioned in 1982, is the only petroleum refinery in Uttar Pradesh.
33. The **UP Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC)** consists of exactly **6 nodes**: **Aligarh, Agra, Kanpur, Chitrakoot, Jhansi, and Lucknow**.
34. The BrahMos Aerospace supersonic cruise missile manufacturing and integration unit is located at the **Lucknow node** of UPDIC.

35. The flagship **One District One Product (ODOP)** scheme was launched on **24 January 2018 (UP Diwas)**.
36. Under ODOP, **Moonj products** are assigned to **Amethi, Sultanpur, and Prayagraj**.
37. Under ODOP, **Home Furnishings** (not wooden toys) is the designated product for **Baghpat**.
38. Under ODOP, **Wooden Toys** are the designated handicraft for **Chitrakoot and Varanasi**.
39. Under ODOP, **Aromatic Kalanamak Rice** is the designated product for **Siddharthnagar**.
40. Under ODOP, **Aonla (Gooseberry)** products are designated for **Pratapgarh**.
41. Under ODOP, **Shajar Stone Craft** is the designated GI product for **Banda**.
42. Under ODOP, **Gaura Stone Craft** is the designated product for **Mahoba**.
43. Under ODOP, **Tarkashi Woodcraft** (brass wire inlay) is designated for **Mainpuri**.
44. The **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km) connects **Greater Noida to Agra**.
45. The **Agra-Lucknow Expressway** (302 km) was constructed by UPEIDA and features a dedicated 3.3 km emergency airstrip in Unnao.
46. The **Purvanchal Expressway** (340.8 km) connects **Lucknow (Chand Saray) to Ghazipur (Haidariya)**, passing through 9 districts.
47. The Purvanchal Expressway **does NOT pass through Basti or Gorakhpur**.
48. The **Bundelkhand Expressway** (296 km) connects **Chitrakoot (Bharatkoop) to Etawah (Kudrail)**, linking into the Agra-Lucknow Expressway.
49. **Noida International Airport (Jewar)** in Gautam Buddha Nagar is developed as a major greenfield international cargo and passenger hub.
50. Under the Central Smart Cities Mission, exactly **10 cities** were selected from Uttar Pradesh (**Ghaziabad is NOT on the Central 10 list**).

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: Industrial Specialization, Mineral Deposits and Manufacturing Hubs of Uttar Pradesh

Industrial Sector / Mineral	Major Hub / District	Key Raw Material / Geological Source	Industrial Output & Key Public / Private Enterprises	Economic Distinction & Exam Focus
Sugar Industry	**Western UP & Terai Belt** (Muzaffarnagar, Meerut, Deoria, Lakhimpur)	High-yield Sugarcane (Co-0238 variety)	Refined white sugar, molasses, ethanol, bagasse co-generation power	• First sugar mill in India set up at **Pratappur (Deoria) in 1903**. • UP is the largest producer of sugarcane in India.
Leather & Footwear	**Kanpur Nagar, Agra, Unnao**	Cattle hides, synthetic polymers, tanning chemicals	Finished leather footwear, saddlery, harnesses, safety shoes, garments	• Kanpur is the "Leather City of the World". • Agra accounts for nearly 28% of total Indian footwear exports. • Dedicated Mega Leather Cluster at Ramaipur (Kanpur).
Cotton & Silk Textiles	**Kanpur ("Manchester of the East")**, **Varanasi, Mau, Mubarakpur (Azamgarh)**	Raw cotton, mulberry/katan silk yarn, zari threads	Cotton yarn, hosiery, handloom Banarasi silk sarees, brocades	• Kanpur flourished with British mills (Elgin Mills, Lal Imli). • Varanasi is world-famous for GI-tagged Banarasi silk and Tanchoi brocades.
Brassware & Metal Handicrafts	**Moradabad ("Peetal Nagari")**, **Hathras, Aligarh**	Copper, zinc (brass ingots), electroplating solutions	Brass utensils, decorative lamps, artistic statues, door fittings	• Moradabad accounts for over **40% of total Indian brassware exports**. • Aligarh is internationally renowned as the **"City of Locks" (Taala Nagari)**.

Industrial Sector / Mineral	Major Hub / District	Key Raw Material / Geological Source	Industrial Output & Key Public / Private Enterprises	Economic Distinction & Exam Focus
Glassware & Bangles	**Firozabad ("Suhag Nagari")**	Silica sand from **Shankargarh (Prayagraj)**, soda ash, borax	Glass bangles, decorative chandeliers, laboratory glass, bottles	• Firozabad holds a virtual monopoly in Indian glass bangle production. • Center for Development of Glass Industry (CDGI) located here.
Handmade Carpets & Rugs	**Bhadohi ("Carpet City"), Mirzapur, Varanasi**	New Zealand wool, Bikaner wool, cotton-silk warps	Persian-style hand-knotted woollen carpets, tufted rugs, durries	• Bhadohi-Mirzapur belt produces ~**60% of India's total exported handmade carpets** (GI-tagged "Handmade Carpet of Bhadohi").
Perfumes & Essential Oils	**Kannauj ("Attar Nagari" / "Grasse of the East")**	Rose damascena, jasmine, vetiver (*khus*), sandalwood oil	Traditional *Deg-Bhapka* steam-distilled Attar, Shamama, rose water	• Hydro-distillation heritage spanning over 1,000 years; Fragrance and Flavour Development Centre (FFDC) located here.
Aluminium Smelting	**Renukoot (Sonbhadra)**	Bauxite from Lohardaga/Amarkantak, cheap hydel/thermal power from **Rihand Dam**	Primary aluminium ingots, sheets, extrusions	• Site of **HINDALCO (Aditya Birla Group)**, one of the largest integrated aluminium plants in Asia.
Heavy Electricals & Engineering	**Noida, Greater Noida, Ghaziabad, Jhansi, Jagdishpur (Amethi)**	Steel, copper conductors, electronic microchips	Transformers, power plant boilers, rolling stock, mobile phones	• **BHEL** plants at Jhansi (Transformers) and Jagdishpur. • Noida-Greater Noida is India's largest **Mobile Phone & Electronics Manufacturing Hub** (Samsung, Oppo).
Cement Industry	**Churk, Dalla, Chunar (Sonbhadra & Mirzapur)**	Kajrahat Limestone deposits, Fly ash from NTPC plants	Portland Pozzolana Cement (PPC), Clinker	• Limestone quarries of Vindhyan system; UP State Cement Corporation mills and private plants.
Mineral: Coal	**Singrauli Coalfield (Sonbhadra)**	Gondwana sedimentary rock strata	Non-coking thermal grade coal (feeds NTPC Singrauli & Rihand)	• Only district in UP with commercial coal mining (Northern Coalfields Ltd).
Mineral: Uranium & Copper	**Lalitpur District**	Bijawar & Vindhyan rock formations	Minor radioactive traces, copper mineralization at Sonrai	• Lalitpur is the **only district in UP where Uranium traces** have been discovered.
Mineral: Silica Sand (Glass Sand)	**Shankargarh & Mau (Prayagraj / Chitrakoot)**	Vindhyan sandstone weathering	High-grade silica sand (>98\%\ ext{SiO}_2)	• Supplies raw silica sand to glass industries of Firozabad and ceramic units of Khurja.
Mineral: Limestone	**Kajrahat (Sonbhadra), Guruma-Kanach (Mirzapur)**	Vindhyan Limestone	Flux grade & cement grade limestone	• Meets the raw material requirements of Sonbhadra/Mirzapur cement factories.
Mineral: Diaspore & Pyrophyllite	**Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Hamirpur**	Hydrothermal alteration zones in Bundelkhand Gneiss	Refractory bricks, ceramics, insecticides	• UP is the leading producer of Diaspore and Pyrophyllite in India.

Table 2: The UP One District One Product (ODOP) Master Matrix

The flagship **One District One Product (ODOP)** scheme was launched by the UP Government on **24 January 2018 (UP Diwas)** to revive indigenous crafts, promote MSME exports, and generate local rural/semi-urban employment

across all **75 districts**:

Division / Region	District	ODOP Flagship Product	Key Distinction / GI Status
Western UP / NCR	**Aligarh**	**Locks & Metal Hardware**	"Taala Nagari" — Famous for brass padlocks and architectural hardware.
	Agra	**Leather Goods & Zari Zardozi / Petha**	Major leather shoes and marble inlay cluster.
	Firozabad	**Glass Products & Bangles**	World-renowned "Suhag Nagari".
	Mathura	**Sansthakala / Brass Idols & Peda**	Traditional Kanha metal deities and milk sweets.
	Mainpuri	**Tarkashi Art**	Intricate brass/copper wire inlay in seasoned sheesham wood (GI-tagged).
	Hathras	**Hing (Asafoetida)**	Traditional spice processing hub of India.
	Meerut	**Sports Goods**	India's premier cricket bat and athletic equipment hub (GI-tagged).
	Saharanpur	**Wood Carving**	Exquisite carved Sheesham wood screens, furniture, and boxes (GI-tagged).
	Moradabad	**Metal Craft (Brassware)**	Largest brass exporter of India.
	Sambhal	**Horn & Bone Handicrafts**	Ecological artistic items carved from fallen animal horns and bones.
	Amroha	**Musical Instruments (Dholak)**	Traditional mango-wood dholak and percussion instruments.
	Bulandshahr	**Ceramics & Pottery (Khurja)**	"Ceramic City" — High-temperature glazed crockery and electrical insulators.
	Muzaffarnagar	**Jaggery (Gud)**	Largest jaggery trading market (*Gud Mandi*) in Asia.
	Baghpat	**Home Furnishings**	Handloom cotton bedsheets and weaves (Note: NOT wooden toys).
	Gautam Buddha Nagar	**Apparel & Readymade Garments**	Major garment export hub along Noida SEZ.
Central / Awadh	**Lucknow**	**Chikankari & Zari Zardozi**	400-year-old delicate white-on-white hand embroidery (GI-tagged).
	Kanpur Nagar	**Leather Products**	Global saddle, footwear, and industrial leather hub.
	Kanpur Dehat	**Aluminium Utensils**	Pressed aluminium cookware.
	Kannauj	**Attar (Perfume) & Essential Oils**	Traditional hydro-distilled natural perfumes.
	Unnao	**Zari Zardozi & Leather**	Leather tanneries and gold/silver embroidery.
	Rae Bareli	**Woodwork**	Carved woodwork and timber products.
	Sitapur	**Durries (Cotton/Wool Carpets)**	Traditional Laharpur flat-woven floor rugs.
	Hardoi	**Handloom Products**	Mallawan handloom fabrics.
	Lakhimpur Kheri	**Tribal Crafts & Jaggery**	Tharu tribal handicraft and sugarcane products.
	Amethi	**Moonj Products**	Natural wild grass (*Saccharum sara*) basketry and decorative mats.
	Sultanpur	**Moonj Products**	Moonj grass handicrafts.
	Ayodhya (Faizabad)	**Jaggery (Gud)**	Sugarcane jaggery processing.
	Barabanki	**Handloom Weaving**	Cotton and poly-silk handloom textiles.

Division / Region	District	ODOP Flagship Product	Key Distinction / GI Status
Bundelkhand	**Jhansi**	**Soft Toys**	Stuffed plush toys manufacturing cluster.
	Lalitpur	**Zari Silk Sarees & Metal Craft**	Handwoven Chanderi-style Zari silk sarees.
	Mahoba	**Gaura Stone Craft**	Soft white pyrophyllite stone carvings and statues (GI-tagged).
	Hamirpur	**Handmade Shoes (Jutti)**	Traditional embroidered Bundelkhandi leather footwear.
	Banda	**Shajar Stone Craft**	Natural dendritic moss-agate gemstone carving (GI-tagged).
	Chitrakoot	**Wooden Toys**	Carved wooden lacquer toys and religious artifacts.
	Jalaun	**Handmade Paper (Kalpi)**	Traditional eco-friendly recycled handmade paper (GI-tagged).
Eastern / Purvanchal	**Varanasi**	**Banarasi Silk & Gulabi Meenakari**	World-famous silk brocades and pink enamel jewellery.
	Bhadohi	**Handmade Carpets (Kaleen)**	Global capital of hand-knotted woollen carpets.
	Mirzapur	**Carpets & Brass Utensils**	Hand-tufted carpets and metal casting.
	Gorakhpur	**Terracotta Craft**	Traditional natural clay figures, elephants, and bells (GI-tagged).
	Azamgarh	**Black Clay Pottery (Nizamabad)**	Distinctive polished black pottery with silver inlay (GI-tagged).
	Siddharthnagar	**Kalanamak Rice**	"Buddha's Rice" — Highly aromatic black-husked scented rice (GI-tagged).
	Prayagraj	**Moonj Products & Guava (Surkha)**	Allahabad Surkha red guava and Moonj crafts.
	Pratapgarh	**Aonla (Indian Gooseberry)**	Premier Aonla processing cluster (murabba, candy, juice).
	Ghazipur	**Jute Wall Hangings**	Handcrafted decorative jute wall hangings.
	Jaunpur	**Woollen Carpets & Imarti**	Traditional woollen durries and sweets.
	Ballia	**Bindi Industry**	Decorative forehead bindi manufacturing.
	Sonbhadra	**Carpets & Stone Artefacts**	Woollen floor coverings and mineral-based crafts.

Table 3: Infrastructure, Defence Corridor, Energy Plants & Logistics Corridors

Infrastructure Component	Key Nodes / Project Extent	Length / Capacity / Agency	Strategic Economic & Regional Impact
UP Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC)	**6 Nodes**: **Aligarh, Agra, Kanpur, Chitrakoot, Jhansi, Lucknow**	UPEIDA (Implementing Agency); 6 nodes covering Western, Central, and Bundelkhand UP	• Attracts domestic and global aerospace & defence investments (BrahMos missile integration unit at **Lucknow**, small arms at Kanpur, UAVs at Aligarh, ammunition at Jhansi).
Yamuna Expressway	**Greater Noida to Agra**	**165 km** (6-lane expandable to 8-lane); YEIDA	• First access-controlled super-expressway in UP (operational since 2012); cuts Delhi-Agra travel to 2 hours.
Agra-Lucknow Expressway	**Agra to Lucknow** (via Firozabad, Mainpuri, Etawah, Auraiya, Kannauj, Kanpur Dehat, Hardoi, Unnao)	**302 km** (6-lane); UPEIDA	• Features a 3.3 km dedicated airstrip at Unnao for emergency IAF fighter jet landings.

Infrastructure Component	Key Nodes / Project Extent	Length / Capacity / Agency	Strategic Economic & Regional Impact
Purvanchal Expressway	**Chand Saray (Lucknow) to Haidariya (Ghazipur)** (via Barabanki, Amethi, Sultanpur, Ayodhya, Ambedkar Nagar, Azamgarh, Mau)	**340.8 km** (6-lane); UPEIDA	• Lifeline of Eastern UP; 3.2 km emergency airstrip at Kurebhar (Sultanpur). Does NOT pass through Basti or Gorakhpur.
Bundelkhand Expressway	**Gonda (near Bharatkoop, Chitrakoot) to Kudrail (Etawah)** (via Banda, Mahoba, Hamirpur, Jalaun, Auraiya)	**296 km** (4-lane expandable to 6-lane); UPEIDA	• Integrates the backward Bundelkhand region directly into the Agra-Lucknow Expressway network.
Ganga Expressway (Under Construction)	**Meerut to Prayagraj (Judapur Dandu)** (via Hapur, Bulandshahr, Amroha, Sambhal, Badaun, Shahjahanpur, Hardoi, Unnao, Rae Bareli, Pratapgarh)	**594 km** (6-lane expandable to 8-lane); UPEIDA	• Longest expressway in UP; emergency airstrip at Shahjahanpur; connects western border to eastern Sangam.
Thermal Power Stations	• **Obra & Anpara** (Sonbhadra) • **Singrauli Super Thermal & Rihand** (Sonbhadra - NTPC) • **Harduaganj** (Aligarh - Oldest in UP, 1942) • **Parichha** (Jhansi) • **Panki** (Kanpur) • **Jawaharpur** (Etah) • **Meja & Tanda** (Prayagraj / Ambedkar Nagar - NTPC)	Total installed capacity: >25,000 ext{ MW} (State sector: UPRVUNL; Central: NTPC)	• Sonbhadra is known as the **"Energy Capital of India"** due to massive pithead thermal stations fueled by Singrauli coalfields.
Nuclear Power Station	**Narora Atomic Power Station (NAPS)**, Bulandshahr district	2 imes 220 ext{ MWe} (Pressurized Heavy Water Reactors - PHWR); NPCIL	• **Only nuclear power station in Uttar Pradesh** (Unit 1 commissioned 1991, Unit 2 in 1992); uses water from the Upper Ganga Canal for cooling.
Hydro-Electric Power Plants	• **Rihand Project (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)**, Pipri (Sonbhadra - 300 MW) • **Obra Hydel Project** (Rihand River - 99 MW) • **Matatila Dam Project** (Betwa River, Lalitpur - 30.6 MW) • **Rajghat Hydel Project** (Betwa River - UP-MP Joint Venture) • **Khara Hydel Project** (Asan River, Saharanpur - 72 MW)	State Hydel Grid (UPJVNL)	• Primary hydel generation located in southern plateau (Vindhyan-Bundelkhand) and northern foothills.
Major Oil Refinery	**Mathura Refinery (Indian Oil Corporation - IOCL)**	Capacity: 8.0 MMTPA (Commissioned 1982)	• Processes crude oil piped from Vadinar (Gujarat); produces petrol, diesel, aviation fuel, and petrochemical feedstocks. Highly scrutinized for emissions near Taj Mahal (Taj Trapezium Zone).

One-Liner Revision – UP Economy

#	Fast Fact
1	UP = 2nd largest State economy by GSDP (after Maharashtra)
2	UP = largest sugarcane-producing State

#	Fast Fact
3	UP = largest sugar mill State (over 100 sugar mills)
4	UP = largest potato-producing State
5	UP = largest milk-producing State
6	UP = 2nd largest wheat-producing State (after MP/Punjab)
7	ODOP launched = **2018** (75 districts – 75 products)
8	Moradabad = **"Peetal Nagari"** (brass ware exports)
9	Firozabad = **"Suhag Nagari"** (80%+ of India's bangles)
10	Aligarh = **"Lock City"** (50%+ India's padlocks)
11	Kanpur = leather goods hub (second to Agra)
12	Bhadohi/Mirzapur = **"Carpet City"**
13	Noida = IT/Electronics corridor; part of NCR
14	Lucknow = Chikankari (GI tag) + Zardozi embroidery
15	Kannauj = **Ittar (perfume) city** of India

Topic 5 — Agriculture, Irrigation and Rural Economy

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. Uttar Pradesh is divided into **9 Agro-Climatic Zones** by the Planning Commission.
2. The **South-Western Semi-Arid Zone** (Agra, Mathura) receives the **lowest rainfall** in Uttar Pradesh.
3. The **Bhabhar & Terai Zone** receives the **highest rainfall** in Uttar Pradesh.
4. **Tube-wells (Nalkoop)** account for approximately **74.9%** of the net irrigated area in UP.
5. **Canals (Nahar)** constitute the second largest source of irrigation in UP (~**15.2%**).
6. **Private tube-wells** alone irrigate over 71% of UP's cultivated farm area.
7. Uttar Pradesh has the largest total replenishable groundwater resource in India (~**40.7 bcm**).
8. The **Upper Ganga Canal** was opened on **8 April 1854**, engineered by **Sir Proby Cautley** with its offtake at **Bhimgoda, Haridwar**.
9. The **Lower Ganga Canal** was commissioned in **1878** with its offtake barrage at **Narora, Bulandshahr**.
10. The **Sharda Canal System**, commissioned in **1928** from **Banbasa**, is the **longest canal network** in UP (~12,368 km total system).
11. The **Eastern Yamuna Canal** has its offtake at **Tajewala / Hathinikund Barrage** (Saharanpur border).
12. The **Agra Canal** was opened in **1874** with its headworks at **Okhla Barrage (Delhi)** on the Yamuna.
13. The **Saryu Nahar National Project**, dedicated in December 2021, interlinks 5 rivers (Ghaghara, Saryu, Rapti, Banganga, Rohini) across 9 districts.
14. The **Ken-Betwa River Interlinking Project** is India's first national river interlink, transferring water via **Daudhan Dam** to Bundelkhand.
15. **Matatila Dam (Rani Lakshmibai Dam)** is built on the **Betwa River** in **Lalitpur district**.
16. **Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)**, the largest reservoir by volume in India, is built on the **Rihand River** at Pipri (**Sonbhadra**).
17. **Chandauli district** is traditionally known as the **"Rice Bowl of Uttar Pradesh"** (Dhan ka Katora).
18. Uttar Pradesh ranks **#1 in India** in the production of **Wheat, Sugarcane, Potato, and Milk**.
19. UP produces over **32%–35% of total wheat** and ~**35% of total potatoes** in India.
20. The International Potato Center - South Asia Regional Centre (**CIP-SARC**) is located at **Singna, Agra** (NOT Aligarh).
21. The International Rice Research Institute - South Asia Regional Centre (**IRRI-SARC**) is located at **Varanasi**.
22. The **Indian Institute of Pulses Research (IIPR)** is situated at **Kalyanpur, Kanpur**.
23. The **Indian Institute of Sugarcane Research (IISR)** is situated at **Lucknow**.
24. The **National Sugar Institute (NSI)** is situated at **Kalyanpur, Kanpur** (under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, GoI).
25. The **Indian Institute of Vegetable Research (IIVR)** is situated at **Jakhini, Varanasi**.
26. The **Indian Veterinary Research Institute (IVRI)** and **Central Avian Research Institute (CARI)** are located at **Izatnagar, Bareilly**.
27. The **Central Institute for Research on Goats (CIRG)** is located at **Makhdoom, Farah in Mathura district**.
28. The **Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute (IGFRI)** and **CAFRI** are located at **Jhansi**.
29. The **Central Institute for Subtropical Horticulture (CISH)** is situated at **Rehmankhera, Lucknow**.
30. The **Central Institute of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (CIMAP)** is located at **Lucknow**.
31. Uttar Pradesh accounts for over **80% of India's total Mentha (Peppermint) oil output**, centred in **Barabanki, Badaun, Rampur, and Sambhal**.
32. **Malihabad (Lucknow)** is world-renowned for its GI-tagged **Dasheri Mango**.
33. **Prayagraj (Allahabad)** and Kaushambi are famous for the **Allahabad Surkha Guava** (red flesh, GI-tagged).

34. **Pratapgarh district** is the largest producer of **Aonla (Indian Gooseberry)** in India.
35. **Mahoba** is historically celebrated for its high-grade **Paan (Betel Vine / Bareja)** cultivation.
36. **Chandra Shekhar Azad University of Agriculture & Technology (CSAUAT)** was established at **Kanpur in 1975**.
37. **Acharya Narendra Deva University of Agriculture & Technology (ANDUAT)** was established at **Kumarganj (Ayodhya) in 1975**.
38. **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel University of Agriculture & Technology (SVPUAT)** was established at **Meerut in 2000**.
39. **Banda University of Agriculture & Technology (BUAT)** was established at **Banda in 2010**.
40. **Rani Lakshmi Bai Central Agricultural University** was established in **Jhansi in 2014** by an Act of Parliament.
41. The first agricultural university of undivided Uttar Pradesh was **Govind Ballabh Pant University of Agriculture & Technology (GBPUAT)**, set up at **Pantnagar in 1960** (now in Uttarakhand).
42. The **Arjun Sahayak Project** provides irrigation to Mahoba, Banda, and Hamirpur using waters of the Dhasan River.
43. **Western Uttar Pradesh** was the principal beneficiary of the **Green Revolution (1960s)** in UP due to canal and tubewell networks.
44. **Bundelkhand** is the primary **pulses (gram, lentil, arhar)** and **oilseeds (sesame, mustard)** producing region of UP.
45. **Saryupar Plain** (Gorakhpur, Deoria, Basti) has witnessed the fastest growth in shallow tubewell irrigation.
46. The **Pradeshik Cooperative Dairy Federation (PCDF)** markets milk under the popular brand name **"Parag"**.
47. Under the UP Bovine Breeding Policy, the **Frieswal crossbred cattle** was developed at **CIRC, Meerut**.
48. **Badua Dam** is located in **Bihar** (often placed as a distractor in UP PSC dam matching questions).
49. **Ahraura Dam, Adwa Dam, and Sirsi Dam** are located in **Mirzapur district**.
50. **Parichha Dam** is built on the **Betwa River in Jhansi district**.

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: The 9 Agro-Climatic Zones of Uttar Pradesh (Planning Commission Classification)

Agro-Climatic Zone	Geographical Extent & Key Districts	Soil Type & Climatic Features	Annual Rainfall Range	Principal Crops & Agricultural Specialization
1. Bhabhar & Terai Zone	Saharanpur, Muzaffarnagar, Bijnor, Rampur, Bareilly, Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj, Kushinagar	High moisture, rich clayey-loam alluvium with high organic matter; sub-humid	**1,200 – 1,500 mm** (High rainfall)	**Paddy, Sugarcane, Wheat, Jute, Mustard, Mentha, Kalanamak Rice**
2. Western Plain Zone	Meerut, Baghpat, Bulandshahr, Ghaziabad, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Hapur, Muzaffarnagar, Shamli, Saharanpur	Fertile light/medium sandy loam; semi-arid to sub-humid	**600 – 800 mm**	**Sugarcane (Co-0238), Wheat, Maize, Mustard, Potato, Fodder crops**
3. Mid-Western Plain Zone	Badaun, Shahjahanpur, Moradabad, Sambhal, Amroha, Rampur, Bareilly, Pilibhit	Sandy loam to clayey alluvium; sub-humid	**800 – 1,000 mm**	**Wheat, Sugarcane, Rice, Mentha (Peppermint), Mustard, Pulses**
4. South-Western Semi-Arid Zone	Agra, Mathura, Firozabad, Mainpuri, Aligarh, Hathras, Etah, Kasganj	Alluvial soil with sandy loam and saline/alkaline patches; semi-arid	**600 – 750 mm** (Lowest rainfall)	**Mustard (Rapeseed), Wheat, Bajra (Pearl Millet), Barley, Potato**

Agro-Climatic Zone	Geographical Extent & Key Districts	Soil Type & Climatic Features	Annual Rainfall Range	Principal Crops & Agricultural Specialization
5. Central Plain Zone	Lucknow, Unnao, Rae Bareli, Sitapur, Hardoi, Kanpur Nagar, Kanpur Dehat, Fatehpur, Kaushambi, Prayagraj, Pratapgarh	Medium to heavy alluvial loam with *Reh / Usar* (saline-alkali) tracts	**800 – 1,000 mm**	**Wheat, Paddy, Gram, Potato, Guava (Surkha), Aonla, Dasheri Mango**
6. Bundelkhand Zone	Jhansi, Lalitpur, Jalaun, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot (7 districts)	Mixed red and black soils (*Rakar, Parwa, Kabar, Mar*); semi-arid, rocky	**800 – 950 mm** (Erratic, prone to drought)	**Gram (Chana), Lentil (Masoor), Arhar, Mustard, Sesame (Til), Jowar**
7. North-Eastern Plain Zone	Gorakhpur, Deoria, Kushinagar, Maharajganj, Basti, Sant Kabir Nagar, Siddharthnagar, Gonda, Bahraich	Deep alluvial silt and clay loam; sub-humid to humid	**1,000 – 1,200 mm**	**Paddy, Wheat, Sugarcane, Lentils, Maize, Mustard**
8. Eastern Plain Zone	Varanasi, Jaunpur, Ghazipur, Azamgarh, Mau, Ballia, Chandauli, Faizabad (Ayodhya), Ambedkar Nagar, Sultanpur, Amethi	Medium alluvial loam, clay loam (*Khadar* in floodplains); sub-humid	**1,000 – 1,200 mm**	**Paddy, Wheat, Pulses (Arhar/Gram), Sugarcane, Vegetables, Potato**
9. Vindhyan Zone	Mirzapur, Sonbhadra, southern parts of Prayagraj and Chandauli	Undulating red gravelly, sandy loam, lateritic soils; sub-humid to dry	**1,000 – 1,100 mm**	**Paddy, Wheat, Gram, Arhar, Mustard, Millets (Kodo/Kutki), Sesame**

Table 2: Major Canal Networks, Dams and Irrigation Systems in Uttar Pradesh

Canal Network / Dam Project	River / Water Source	Offtake / Barrage Location	Total System Length / Command Area	Beneficiary Districts & Historical Distinction
Upper Ganga Canal (1854)	**Ganga River**	**Bhimgoda Barrage, Haridwar** (Uttarakhand)	Main canal: ~295 km; Total system: ~6,500 km	• Designed by **Sir Proby T. Cautley**; opened on **8 April 1854**. • Irrigates Western UP: Saharanpur, Muzaffarnagar, Meerut, Bulandshahr, Aligarh, Mathura, Agra, Etawah, Kanpur.
Lower Ganga Canal (1878)	**Ganga River**	**Narora Barrage, Bulandshahr**	Main canal: ~100 km; Total system: ~8,200 km	• Opened in **1878**. • Supplies cooling water to Narora Atomic Power Station; irrigates Bulandshahr, Aligarh, Etah, Mainpuri, Farrukhabad, Kanpur, Fatehpur, Prayagraj.
Sharda Canal System (1928)	**Sharda (Kali) River**	**Banbasa Barrage** (Pilibhit / Champawat border)	Total network length: **~12,368 km** (Longest canal network in UP)	• Commissioned in **1928**. • Irrigates 16 districts of Central and Terai UP: Pilibhit, Bareilly, Shahjahanpur, Lakhimpur, Hardoi, Sitapur, Lucknow, Unnao, Rae Bareli, Barabanki, Prayagraj.
Eastern Yamuna Canal	**Yamuna River**	**Tajewala / Hathinikund Barrage** (Saharanpur border)	Total system: ~1,440 km	• Originally dug during Mughal era (Shah Jahan); remodeled by British engineers (Col. John Colvin) in **1830**. • Irrigates Saharanpur, Shamli, Muzaffarnagar, Meerut, Baghpat, Ghaziabad.
Agra Canal (1874)	**Yamuna River**	**Okhla Barrage, Delhi**	Total system: ~1,600 km	• Opened in **1874**. • Traverses Delhi, Haryana, and irrigates Mathura, Agra, and parts of Rajasthan (Bharatpur).

Canal Network / Dam Project	River / Water Source	Offtake / Barrage Location	Total System Length / Command Area	Beneficiary Districts & Historical Distinction
Sarda Sahayak Project	**Ghaghara & Sharda Rivers**	**Katarniaghat Barrage** (Bahraich) on Ghaghara & Sharda feeder canal	Huge feeder channel (~260 km)	• Augments water supply to the tail-ends of the Sharda Canal system in Awadh and Purvanchal (Lucknow, Rae Bareli, Sultanpur, Jaunpur, Azamgarh, Ghazipur).
Saryu Nahar National Project	**5 Rivers: Ghaghara, Saryu, Rapti, Banganga, Rohini**	Barrages on Ghaghara, Saryu, and Rapti	Over **6,600 km** of canals; dedicated Dec 2021	• Massive project benefiting ~29 lakh farmers across **9 districts of Eastern UP**: Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Gonda, Siddharthnagar, Basti, Sant Kabir Nagar, Gorakhpur, Maharajganj.
Ken-Betwa River Interlinking	**Ken & Betwa Rivers**	**Daudhan Dam** (Chhatarpur, MP) & 221 km link canal	Transfers surplus water from Ken basin to Betwa basin	• **India's first National River Interlinking Project** under implementation. • Provides critical irrigation and drinking water to drought-prone **Bundelkhand** (Banda, Mahoba, Jhansi, Lalitpur in UP).
Matatila Dam (Rani Lakshmibai Dam)	**Betwa River**	**Lalitpur District** (UP-MP border)	Storage capacity: 1,132 MCM; 30.6 MW Hydel	• Constructed in **1958**; irrigates Jhansi, Jalaun, Hamirpur, and Lalitpur via Betwa canal network.
Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar)	**Rihand River** (Tributary of Son)	**Pipri, Sonbhadra District**	Reservoir surface area: ~466 km^2 (Largest man-made reservoir in India)	• Constructed in **1962**; concrete gravity dam powering HINDALCO aluminium plant and thermal stations, feeding canals in Sonbhadra/Mirzapur.

Table 3: Premier Central & State Agricultural, Veterinary & Forest Research Institutes in UP

Research Institute / University	Location / District	Controlling Body / Affiliation	Founding Year	Core Scientific Focus & Mandate
Indian Institute of Pulses Research (IIPR)	**Kalyanpur, Kanpur**	ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research)	**1983**	National nodal research institute for genetic improvement, crop management, and seed production of pulses (chana, arhar, moong, masoor).
Indian Institute of Sugarcane Research (IISR)	**Lucknow (Telibagh)**	ICAR	**1952**	Spearheads sugarcane breeding, mechanization, ratoon management, and bio-energy technologies.
National Sugar Institute (NSI)	**Kalyanpur, Kanpur**	Dept of Food & Public Distribution, GoI	**1936**	Premier institute for sugar technology, sugar engineering, alcohol technology, and fermentation technology (NOT under ICAR).
Indian Institute of Vegetable Research (IIVR)	**Jakhini, Varanasi**	ICAR	**1999**	Lead institute for vegetable germplasm breeding, disease resistance, and hybrid vegetable production (Kashi hybrid varieties).
Indian Veterinary Research Institute (IVRI)	**Izatnagar, Bareilly**	ICAR (Deemed University)	**1889**	India's premier veterinary institute; research in livestock health, vaccine manufacturing, and animal genetics.
Central Avian Research Institute (CARI)	**Izatnagar, Bareilly**	ICAR	**1979**	Specializes in poultry breeding (chicken, quail, turkey, guinea fowl), nutrition, and processing.
Central Institute for Research on Goats (CIRG)	**Makhdoom, Farah (Mathura)**	ICAR	**1979**	Dedicated to goat genetics (Jamunapari, Barbari), reproductive biotechnology, and goat meat/milk products.

Research Institute / University	Location / District	Controlling Body / Affiliation	Founding Year	Core Scientific Focus & Mandate
Central Cattle Breeding Farm / CIRC	**Meerut (Brahmpuri)**	ICAR	**1987**	Research on cattle genetic improvement (Frieswal crossbred cattle) and indigenous bovine breeds (Sahiwal, Gir).
Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute (IGFRI)	**Jhansi**	ICAR	**1962**	National research on forage crops, pastures, silvopasture systems, and grassland management in semi-arid zones.
Central Agroforestry Research Institute (CAFRI)	**Jhansi**	ICAR	**1988**	Develops sustainable agroforestry models, watershed management, and tree-crop integration for rainfed regions.
Central Potato Research Station (CPRS)	**Modipuram, Meerut**	ICAR-CPRI (Shimla Sub-station)	**1957**	Breeder seed production and potato breeding for the Indo-Gangetic plains (Kufri varieties).
International Potato Center - South Asia Regional Centre (CIP-SARC)	**Singna, Agra**	CIP (Consultative Group on International Agri Research)	**2023**	Global centre for potato and sweet potato breeding, climate resilience, and seed technology (Note: Located at Singna, Agra; NOT Aligarh).
International Rice Research Institute - South Asia Regional Centre (IRRI-SARC)	**Varanasi (NSRTC Campus)**	IRRI (Philippines / ICAR)	**2018**	Regional hub for climate-resilient, bio-fortified rice varieties, direct-seeded rice (DSR), and grain quality labs.
Central Institute for Subtropical Horticulture (CISH)	**Rehmankhera, Lucknow**	ICAR	**1972**	Nodal institute for subtropical fruits (Mango, Guava, Papaya, Bael, Jamun) and pest management.
National Botanical Research Institute (NBRI)	**Lucknow**	CSIR (Council of Scientific & Industrial Research)	**1953**	Plant taxonomy, floriculture, phytoremediation, and herbal drug standardization.
Central Institute of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (CIMAP)	**Lucknow**	CSIR	**1959**	Research on aromatic crops (Mentha/Peppermint, Lemongrass, Palmarosa) and herbal extracts.

One-Liner Revision – UP Agriculture

#	Fast Fact
1	UP = largest producer of **Sugarcane** in India
2	UP = largest producer of **Potato**
3	UP = largest producer of **Milk**
4	UP has the **most sugar mills** in India (100+)
5	Upper Ganga Canal (1854) = oldest major irrigation work; Haridwar barrage
6	Sharda Canal (1928) = eastern UP irrigation from Kali River
7	Rihand Dam reservoir = **Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar** (largest by area)
8	Kharif crops sown in **June-July**; harvested in **Oct-Nov**
9	Rabi crops sown in **Oct-Nov**; harvested in **Mar-Apr**
10	MSP recommended by **CACP** (Commission for Agri Costs and Prices)
11	PMFBY (2016) = Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (crop insurance)
12	e-NAM = National Agriculture Market (online APMC platform)

#	Fast Fact
13	Green Revolution (1960s) = HYV seeds; M.S. Swaminathan led in India
14	UP groundwater irrigation = Tube wells (dominant method)
15	GI Tag: UP products = Banarasi silk, Chikankari, Aligarh locks

Topic 6 — Society, Population, Education and Social Development

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. As per Census 2011, the total population of Uttar Pradesh is **199,812,341** (~**19.98 Crore**).
2. Uttar Pradesh accounts for **16.51% of the total population of India**.
3. If UP were an independent nation, it would be the **5th most populous country in the world**.
4. The **decadal population growth rate** of UP during 2001–2011 was **20.22%** (India: 17.70%).
5. **Gautam Buddha Nagar (49.1%)** recorded the highest decadal growth rate in UP, while **Kanpur Nagar (9.9%)** recorded the lowest.
6. The **population density** of Uttar Pradesh is **829 persons per square kilometer** (India: 382).
7. **Ghaziabad (3,971 persons/km^2)** has the highest population density, while **Lalitpur (242 persons/km^2)** has the lowest.
8. The **sex ratio** of Uttar Pradesh is **912 females per 1000 males** (India: 943).
9. **Jaunpur (1,024)** has the highest sex ratio in UP, followed by Azamgarh (1,019) and Deoria (1,017).
10. **Gautam Buddha Nagar (851)** has the lowest sex ratio in UP.
11. The **child sex ratio (0–6 years)** in UP is **902** (India: 919).
12. **Balrampur (950)** has the highest child sex ratio, while **Baghpat (841)** has the lowest.
13. The **overall literacy rate** of Uttar Pradesh is **67.68%** (Male: 77.28%, Female: 57.18%).
14. The gender gap in literacy in UP is **20.10%**.
15. **Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)** has the highest overall literacy rate in UP.
16. **Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)** has the highest **female literacy rate** in UP.
17. **Shravasti (46.74%)** has the lowest literacy rate in UP across all three metrics (Overall 46.74%, Male 57.16%, Female 34.78%).
18. **77.73%** of UP's population resides in rural areas, while **22.27%** resides in urban areas.
19. **Ghaziabad (67.6%)** has the highest percentage of urban population in UP.
20. **Shravasti (96.54%)** has the highest percentage of rural population (and lowest urban percentage at 3.46%).
21. **Prayagraj (59.54 Lakh)** is the most populous district in UP, while **Mahoba (8.75 Lakh)** is the least populous.
22. The **Scheduled Caste (SC)** population of UP is **4.14 Crore**, constituting **20.69%** of the state's population.
23. Uttar Pradesh has the **largest absolute SC population in India**.
24. **Kaushambi (34.72%)** has the highest percentage of SC population in UP.
25. **Sitapur (14.46 Lakh)** has the highest absolute number of Scheduled Castes in UP.
26. **Baghpat** has both the lowest SC percentage (11.44%) and lowest SC count (1.49 Lakh) in UP.
27. The **Scheduled Tribe (ST)** population of UP is **11.34 Lakh**, constituting only **0.57%** of the state's population.
28. **Sonbhadra** has the highest tribal population in UP, both in absolute terms (3.85 Lakh) and percentage (**20.67%**).
29. The **Tharu tribe** is the most populous scheduled tribe in Uttar Pradesh.
30. The Tharu tribe inhabits the **Terai region** (Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Maharajganj).
31. The Tharu tribe traditionally commemorates **Diwali as a day of mourning / sorrow (*Shoka Parva*)**.
32. The **Bajhar festival** is celebrated by the **Tharu tribe**.
33. The traditional wedding feast of the Tharu community is called **Lathmarva Bhoj**.
34. The **Buxa (Bhoksa) tribe** is primarily concentrated in **Bijnor district**.
35. The Buxa tribe reveres **Chamunda Devi** as their supreme deity.
36. The **Sahariya tribe** is found exclusively in **Lalitpur district** in UP.
37. The **Agariya tribe** (traditional iron smelters) is concentrated in **Sonbhadra district**.
38. The **Kharwar tribe** performs the traditional **Karma dance** and is found in Sonbhadra, Mirzapur, and Chandauli.

39. The **University of Allahabad**, established on **23 September 1887**, was historically renowned as the **"Oxford of the East"**.
40. **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)** was founded in **1916** by **Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya**.
41. **Aligarh Muslim University (AMU)** evolved from the **MAO College**, founded in **1875** by **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**.
42. **Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University (BBAU)** is a Central University situated at **Lucknow** (est. 1996).
43. **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur** was established in **1959** under the Kanpur Indo-American Program.
44. The **Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Lucknow** was founded in **1984**.
45. The **Central Drug Research Institute (CDRI)** is located at **Lucknow** (developed the contraceptive pill 'Saheli').
46. The **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)** is situated at **Lucknow**.
47. The **Harish-Chandra Research Institute (HRI)**, dedicated to Mathematics and Theoretical Physics, is located at **Jhunsi, Prayagraj**.
48. The **V.V. Giri National Labour Institute** is located at **Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar)**.
49. **King George's Medical University (KGMU)** and **SGPGIMS** are located at **Lucknow**.
50. **Sampurnanand Sanskrit University** (Varanasi) traces its origin to the **Sanskrit College** established by **Jonathan Duncan in 1791**.

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: Census 2011 Master Demographic Matrix for Uttar Pradesh (State Aggregate vs District Extremes)

Demographic Indicator	UP State Aggregate	All-India Comparison	Top-Ranked UP District (Highest)	Bottom-Ranked UP District (Lowest)	Crucial Examination Notes & Traps
Total Population	**199,812,341** (~**19.98 Crore**)	**16.51%** of India's population (Rank **#1**)	**Prayagraj** (59.54 Lakh) > Moradabad > Ghaziabad	**Mahoba** (8.75 Lakh) < Chitrakoot < Hamirpur	If UP were an independent nation, it would be the **5th most populous country** in the world (after China, India, USA, Indonesia).
Decadal Growth Rate (2001–2011)	**20.22%**	India: 17.70% (UP growth is higher)	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (49.1%)** > Ghaziabad > Shravasti	**Kanpur Nagar (9.9%)** < Hamirpur < Baghpat	Urban satellite boom in NCR drove GB Nagar; industrial Kanpur stabilized.
Population Density	**829 persons / km²**	India: 382 persons / km² (Rank **#4** among major states)	**Ghaziabad (3,971 / km²)** > Varanasi > Lucknow	**Lalitpur (242 / km²)** < Sonbhadra (270) < Hamirpur	Lalitpur is the only district with density <300 in UP.
Sex Ratio (Females per 1000 Males)	**912**	India: 943 (UP deficit = -31)	**Jaunpur (1,024)** > Azamgarh (1,019) > Deoria (1,017)	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (851)** = Kanpur Dehat / Hardoi (856)	Only **3 districts** in UP have a sex ratio above 1,000 (Jaunpur, Azamgarh, Deoria).
Child Sex Ratio (0–6 Age Group)	**902**	India: 919 (Severe rural-urban distortion)	**Balrampur (950)** > Sant Kabir Nagar > Bahraich	**Baghpat (841)** < Gautam Buddha Nagar (843) < Ghaziabad	Western UP NCR districts exhibit alarming child sex ratio deficits.
Overall Literacy Rate	**67.68%** (~**67.7%**)	India: 73.0% / 74.04%	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)** > Kanpur Nagar > Auraiya	**Shravasti (46.74%)** < Bahraich (49.4%) < Balrampur	Shravasti is the lowest across ALL three literacy indices (Overall, Male, Female).

Demographic Indicator	UP State Aggregate	All-India Comparison	Top-Ranked UP District (Highest)	Bottom-Ranked UP District (Lowest)	Crucial Examination Notes & Traps
Male Literacy Rate	**77.28%** (~**77.3%**)	India: 80.88% / 82.14%	**Gautam Buddha Nagar (88.06%)** > Auraiya > Etawah	**Shravasti (57.16%)** < Bahraich < Balrampur	Gender gap in literacy in UP is **20.10%**.
Female Literacy Rate	**57.18%** (~**57.2%**)	India: 64.64% / 65.46%	**Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)** > Lucknow > Gautam Buddha Nagar	**Shravasti (34.78%)** < Balrampur (37.6%) < Bahraich	Notice that Kanpur Nagar leads female literacy, NOT Gautam Buddha Nagar!
Rural vs Urban Population	• Rural: **77.73%** (15.53 Cr) • Urban: **22.27%** (4.45 Cr)	India: Rural 68.84%, Urban 31.16%	• **Highest Urban %**: **Ghaziabad (67.6%)** > Lucknow (66.2%) • **Highest Rural %**: **Shravasti (96.5%)**	• **Lowest Urban %**: **Shravasti (3.46%)** • **Lowest Rural %**: **Ghaziabad (32.4%)**	UP is heavily rural; absolute urban count (4.45 Cr) is #2 in India after Maharashtra.
Scheduled Caste (SC) Population	**41,357,608** (**20.69%** ~ **20.7%** of UP population)	**16.6%** of India (UP has the largest absolute SC population in India)	• **Highest SC %**: **Kaushambi (34.72%)** > Sitapur > Hardoi • **Highest SC Count**: **Sitapur (14.46 Lakh)**	• **Lowest SC %**: **Baghpat (11.44%)** < Bareilly < Balrampur • **Lowest SC Count**: **Baghpat (1.49 Lakh)**	UP leads India in **absolute SC count**; Punjab leads India in **SC percentage** (31.9%).
Scheduled Tribe (ST) Population	**1,134,273** (**0.57%** of UP population)	**8.6%** of India (Very small tribal proportion in UP)	• **Highest ST %**: **Sonbhadra (20.67%)** > Lalitpur (5.86%) • **Highest ST Count**: **Sonbhadra (3.85 Lakh)**	• **Lowest ST % & Count**: **Baghpat / Kannauj / Jalaun / Badaun / Ayodhya**	Sonbhadra accounts for over one-third of UP's total tribal population.

Table 2: Scheduled Tribes of Uttar Pradesh (Ethnography, Customs & Distribution)

Scheduled Tribe	Primary Districts of Habitat	Cultural Customs, Social Organization & Beliefs	Traditional Festivals & Rituals	Key Examination Fact
Tharu Tribe	**Terai Belt**: Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, Maharajganj	• Matrilineal joint family tradition; women hold dominant household status. • Traditional houses built of bamboo and reed (*Narhul*). • Claim descent from the Rajput royal line of Thar desert (Rajasthan).	• **Celebrates Diwali as a day of mourning / sorrow (*Shoka Parva*)**, offering *Putla Vidhan* to ancestors. • Celebrates **Bajhar festival** in Jyeshtha/Ashadha month. • Perform *Lathmarva Bhoj* in marriage ceremonies.	• **Most populous tribe in Uttar Pradesh**. • Rajiv Gandhi National Tribal College / Tharu Vikas Pariyojana established in Lakhimpur Kheri (1980).
Buxa / Bhoksa Tribe	**Bijnor District** (and foothills of Pilibhit/Kumaon border)	• Patrilineal social structure with gotra divisions (Buxa Rajput, Buxa Brahmin, Buxa Ahir). • Practice bride-price (*Kanya Shulk*) and levirate/sororate marriage.	• Worship **Chamunda Devi** (Kashipur) as their supreme deity. • Celebrate Chaiti Mela at Kashipur and traditional Hindu festivals.	• Second major tribe in Terai; concentrated heavily in **Bijnor district**.

Scheduled Tribe	Primary Districts of Habitat	Cultural Customs, Social Organization & Beliefs	Traditional Festivals & Rituals	Key Examination Fact
Jaunsari Tribe	**Foothills of Saharanpur** (bordering Dehradun/Jaunsar-Bawar)	• Historically practiced fraternal polyandry (*Draupadi Vivah*). • Folk dances: *Harul*, *Raso*, *Ghumsu*.	• Worship Mahasu Devta (manifestation of Lord Shiva). • Celebrate Magh Mela and Bisu festival.	• After bifurcation in 2000, main population stayed in Uttarakhand (Dehradun), with fringes in Saharanpur.
Kharwar (Khairwar) Tribe	**Sonbhadra, Mirzapur, Chandauli, Ghazipur, Deoria, Ballia**	• Historically associated with traditional extraction of Catechu (*Katha*) from Khair trees (*Acacia catechu*). • Known for physical valour and martial traditions.	• Perform the famous **Karma Dance** during autumn/spring harvest. • Worship Badadeoji, Dulhadeo, and Bansapti Devi.	• Major tribal group of the Vindhyan and Sonbhadra plateau region.
Sahariya Tribe	**Lalitpur District** (exclusively)	• Forest-dwelling indigenous group; highly vulnerable tribal group (PVTG).	• Worship forest deities; celebrate traditional tribal dances (*Sahar*, *Lahanga*).	• **Confined exclusively to Lalitpur district** in UP.
Parhaiya / Baiga / Agariya / Chero / Bhuiya	**Sonbhadra District** (exclusively)	• **Agariya**: Traditional iron smelters using charcoal furnaces. • **Baiga**: Traditional herbal medicine practitioners and priest/shaman (*Guniya*). • **Chero & Bhuiya**: Forest gatherers and marginal farmers.	• Nature-worshipping festivals, Sarhul, Karma, and Phagua.	• Sonbhadra is the most tribally diverse district in UP, hosting nearly **10 recognized ST sub-groups**.

Table 3: Premier Central Universities, State Technical Universities, Medical & Scientific Research Institutes in UP

Category	Institution Name	Location / District	Established Year	Academic & Scientific Eminence
Central University	**University of Allahabad**	**Prayagraj**	**1887** (Central status in 2005)	4th oldest university in India; traditionally revered as the **"Oxford of the East"** for producing civil servants and statesmen.
Central University	**Banaras Hindu University (BHU)**	**Varanasi**	**1916**	Founded by **Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya** under the BHU Act, 1915; Asia's largest residential university (features IIT BHU & IMS).
Central University	**Aligarh Muslim University (AMU)**	**Aligarh**	**1920**	Evolved from the **Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College** founded in **1875** by **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**.
Central University	**Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University (BBAU)**	**Lucknow**	**1996**	Central university dedicated to social justice, technology, and inclusive higher education.
Central University	**Rajiv Gandhi National Aviation University (RGNAU)**	**Fursatganj (Amethi)**	**2013**	India's first specialized central aviation university.
Central University	**Rani Lakshmi Bai Central Agricultural University**	**Jhansi**	**2014**	Central agricultural university established for the Bundelkhand region.
Premier Tech Institute	**Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur**	**Kanpur (Kalyanpur)**	**1959**	One of the foremost IITs, established under the Kanpur Indo-American Program (KIAP).

Category	Institution Name	Location / District	Established Year	Academic & Scientific Eminence
Premier Tech Institute	**Motilal Nehru National Institute of Technology (MNNIT)**	**Prayagraj**	**1961** (NIT status 2002)	Premier National Institute of Technology; pioneer in computer science education.
Premier Tech Institute	**Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT)**	**Prayagraj (Jhalwa)**	**1999**	Institute of National Importance for information technology, AI, and robotics.
Management / Labour	**Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Lucknow**	**Lucknow (Prabandh Nagar)**	**1984**	4th IIM established in India; premier management institution.
Management / Labour	**V.V. Giri National Labour Institute**	**Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar)**	**1974**	Autonomous body under the Ministry of Labour & Employment, GoI, for labour economics and industrial relations.
Fundamental Research	**Harish-Chandra Research Institute (HRI)**	**Jhunsi, Prayagraj**	**1966**	Autonomous research institute funded by DAE (Department of Atomic Energy), specializing in Higher Mathematics and Theoretical Physics.
Medical / Health	**Sanjay Gandhi Postgraduate Institute of Medical Sciences (SGPGIMS)**	**Lucknow (Raebareli Road)**	**1983**	Premier tertiary super-specialty medical institute and hospital.
Medical / Health	**King George's Medical University (KGMU)**	**Lucknow (Chowk)**	**1911** (Upgraded 2002)	Iconic medical university established by King George V (as Prince of Wales).
CSIR Cluster Lucknow	• **CDRI** (Central Drug Research Institute - 1951) • **IITR** (Indian Institute of Toxicology Research - 1965) • **NBRI** (National Botanical Research Institute - 1953) • **CIMAP** (Central Inst. of Medicinal & Aromatic Plants - 1959)	**Lucknow**	1951–1965	Lucknow is one of India's largest CSIR biological research clusters (developed drugs like *Centchroman/Saheli* and *Arteether*).
Palaeobotany	**Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)**	**Lucknow**	**1946**	Founded by renowned palaeobotanist **Prof. Birbal Sahni**; global centre for fossil plant and palaeoclimate research.
Fisheries Genetics	**National Bureau of Fish Genetic Resources (NBFGR)**	**Telibagh, Lucknow**	**1983**	ICAR institute for cataloguing and conserving fish genetic resources and aquatic biodiversity.

One-Liner Revision – UP Society and Education

#	Fast Fact
1	UP literacy rate (2011) = **67.7%** (M: 77.3%, F: 57.2%)
2	UP gender literacy gap = **20.1%** (higher than national 16.3%)
3	Lowest literacy district in UP = **Shravasti (46.74%)**
4	Highest literacy district in UP = **Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)**
5	Lowest female literacy in UP = **Shravasti (34.78%)**
6	UP sex ratio (2011) = **912** (below national 943)

#	Fast Fact
7	UP child sex ratio (2011) = **902** (below national 919)
8	UP SC population = **20.70%** of UP (4.14 Crore – largest in India)
9	RTE Act 2009 = free education for **6-14 years** (Article 21A)
10	ICDS = pre-school nutrition via **Anganwadi** centres
11	ASHA = Accredited Social Health Activist (NHM frontline worker)
12	Kanya Sumangala Yojana (2019) = Rs 15,000 in **6 life stages**
13	Mission Shakti (2020) = UP women safety campaign
14	Mukhyamantri Abhyudaya Yojana (2021) = free exam coaching
15	Samagra Shiksha (2018) = merged SSA + RMSA + TE

Topic 7 — Transport, Tourism, Environment and Disaster Management

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **Dudhwa National Park** in **Lakhimpur Kheri** is the **only National Park** in Uttar Pradesh (established 1977).
2. Uttar Pradesh has **4 designated Tiger Reserves**: (1) Dudhwa TR, (2) Pilibhit TR, (3) Amangarh TR, and (4) Ranipur TR.
3. **Ranipur Tiger Reserve** in **Chitrakoot district** was notified in **2022** as India's **53rd Tiger Reserve** and UP's 4th.
4. **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** won the international **TX2 Award in 2020** for doubling its wild tiger count ahead of schedule.
5. The scenic eco-tourism spot **Chuka Beach** is located inside **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** on the Sharda Sagar reservoir.
6. **Amangarh Tiger Reserve (Bijnor)** served as the buffer zone of Corbett National Park prior to the division of UP in 2000.
7. **Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary** in **Chandauli district** is the **oldest wildlife sanctuary** in UP (established in **1957**).
8. **Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary** (2,073 km^2) is the **largest wildlife sanctuary** in Uttar Pradesh by area.
9. **Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary** in **Lalitpur district** (5.4 km^2) is the **smallest wildlife sanctuary** in UP.
10. The **National Chambal Sanctuary** (Agra/Etawah) is a specialized tri-state sanctuary for the conservation of the **Gharial** and **Gangetic River Dolphin**.
11. **Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary** in **Bahraich district** was established in **1975** and is famous for Gangetic dolphins.
12. The **State Animal** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Swamp Deer (Barasingha)** (*Rucervus duvaucelii*).
13. The **State Bird** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*).
14. The **State Tree** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Ashoka** (*Saraca asoca*).
15. The **State Flower** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Palash / Dhak** (*Butea monosperma*).
16. The **State Aquatic Animal** is the **Gangetic Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*).
17. According to the India State of Forest Report (ISFR), the forest cover of Uttar Pradesh is **6.15%** of its total geographic area.
18. The tree cover of Uttar Pradesh is **3.08%** of its total area, making the total green cover **9.23%**.
19. **Sonbhadra district** has the highest forest cover in UP, both in absolute area (**2,528 km^2**) and percentage (**35.29%**).
20. **Bhadohi (Sant Ravidas Nagar)** has the lowest forest cover in UP (both in area: 3.71 km^2 and percentage: **0.37%**).
21. Only two districts in Uttar Pradesh have more than 20% forest cover: **Sonbhadra (35.29%)** and **Chandauli (21.78%)**.
22. The **Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora)** was declared the **first Ramsar site** of Uttar Pradesh in **2005**.
23. **Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary) in Ballia** was declared **India's 100th Ramsar Site** on 5 June 2026.
24. **Sarsai Nawar Wetland** in **Etawah** is world-renowned for its dense congregation of vulnerable Sarus Cranes.
25. **Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)** in **Agra** is a Ramsar wetland featuring a specialized Bear Rescue Centre.
26. **Samaspur Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Rae Bareli district**.
27. **Sandi Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Hardoi district**.
28. **Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Gonda district**.
29. **Saman Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar site located in **Mainpuri district**.
30. **Bakhira Bird Sanctuary** is a Ramsar wetland located in **Sant Kabir Nagar district**.
31. **Haiderpur Wetland** (Muzaffarnagar-Bijnor) was declared a Ramsar site in **December 2021**.
32. **Patna Bird Sanctuary** is located in **Jalesar (Etah district)**.

33. **Rudrasagar Lake** (Tripura), **Sultanpur National Park** (Haryana), and **Surinsar-Mansar** (J&K) are frequently tested Ramsar sites that are **NOT in Uttar Pradesh**.
34. The **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km) was the first access-controlled expressway in UP, connecting Greater Noida to Agra.
35. The **Agra-Lucknow Expressway** (302 km) features a dedicated 3.3 km emergency airstrip in Unnao district.
36. The **Purvanchal Expressway** (340.8 km) connects **Lucknow (Chand Saray) to Ghazipur (Haidariya)** via Mau (does NOT pass through Basti).
37. The **Bundelkhand Expressway** (296 km) connects **Chitrakoot (Bharatkoop) to Etawah (Kudrail)**.
38. The **Ganga Expressway** (594 km) connects **Meerut to Prayagraj**, traversing 12 districts.
39. Uttar Pradesh has **5 International Airports**: Lucknow, Varanasi, Kushinagar, Ayodhya Dham, and Noida (Jewar).
40. **Kushinagar Airport** was upgraded to international status on **24 June 2020** to facilitate Buddhist pilgrimage.
41. **Noida International Airport at Jewar** is located in **Gautam Buddha Nagar district**.
42. The headquarters of the **North Eastern Railway (NER)** is located at **Gorakhpur**.
43. The headquarters of the **North Central Railway (NCR)** is located at **Prayagraj (Subedarganj)**.
44. **Gorakhpur Railway Station** features one of the world's longest railway platforms at **1,366.3 metres**.
45. **National Waterway 1 (NW-1)** operates on the **Ganga River** connecting **Prayagraj to Haldia (1,620 km)**.
46. The country's first inland **Multimodal Freight Terminal** on NW-1 was inaugurated at **Ralhupur, Varanasi** in November 2018.
47. Uttar Pradesh has operational metro transit systems in **6 cities**: Lucknow, Kanpur, Agra, Noida-Greater Noida, Ghaziabad, and Meerut.
48. The **Taj Trapezium Zone (TTZ)** covers an area of **10,400 km²** around the Taj Mahal to prevent air pollution damage.
49. The **Uttar Pradesh State Disaster Management Authority (UPSDMA)** is headed by the **Chief Minister**.
50. **Eastern UP (Terai/Purvanchal)** is highly prone to **recurrent river floods**, while **Bundelkhand** is prone to **chronic agricultural drought**.

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: National Parks, Tiger Reserves and Major Wildlife Sanctuaries in Uttar Pradesh

Protected Area / Category	Location / Districts	Established Year / Area	Key Flora & Fauna Species	Strategic Environmental & Exam Focus
Dudhwa National Park	**Lakhimpur Kheri District**	**1977** (Declared NP); Area: **490 km²**	Sal forests (*Shorea robusta*), Swamp Deer (**Barasingha** — State Animal), Royal Bengal Tiger, One-Horned Rhinoceros (reintroduced 1984), Hispid Hare, Bengal Florican	• **Only National Park in Uttar Pradesh**. • Core zone of Dudhwa Tiger Reserve; encompasses moist Terai alluvial grassland and swamps.
Dudhwa Tiger Reserve	**Lakhimpur Kheri & Bahraich Districts**	**1987–88** (Project Tiger); Area: **2,201 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Elephants, Swamp Deer, Gangetic Dolphins, Gharials	• Comprises 3 contiguous units: (1) **Dudhwa National Park**, (2) **Kishanpur Wildlife Sanctuary**, (3) **Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary**.

Protected Area / Category	Location / Districts	Established Year / Area	Key Flora & Fauna Species	Strategic Environmental & Exam Focus
Pilibhit Tiger Reserve	**Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri & Bahraich**	**2014** (Declared TR); Area: **730 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Swamp Deer, Bengal Florican, Fishing Cat	• Awarded the prestigious international **TX2 Award (2020)** for doubling its tiger population ahead of schedule. • Eco-tourism destination **Chuka Beach** is located on the Sharda Sagar reservoir inside Pilibhit TR.
Amangarh Tiger Reserve	**Bijnor District**	**2012** (Declared TR); Area: **95 km²**	Asian Elephants, Tigers, Sambar, Cheetal, Barking Deer	• Originally the buffer zone of **Jim Corbett National Park**; remained in UP after Corbett went to Uttarakhand in 2000.
Ranipur Tiger Reserve	**Chitrakoot District**	**2022** (Declared 53rd TR of India / 4th TR in UP); Area: **529.8 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Sloth Bears, Hyenas, Chowsingha (Four-horned Antelope), Blackbucks	• **First Tiger Reserve in the Bundelkhand region** of UP. • Vital wildlife corridor connecting Panna Tiger Reserve (MP) with the Vindhyan forests of UP.
Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary	**Chandauli District** (Vindhyan range)	**1957** (Oldest WLS in UP); Area: **78 km²**	Leopards, Chinkara, Blackbucks, Sambar, Waterfalls (Rajdari & Devdari)	• **Oldest Wildlife Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh** (est. 1957). • Historically selected for the Asiatic Lion introduction experiment (1957–1960).
Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary	**Meerut, Muzaffarnagar, Bijnor, Hapur, Amroha**	**1986**; Area: **2,073 km²**	Swamp Deer, Gangetic Dolphin, Otters, Gharials, Hog Deer	• **Largest Wildlife Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh by area** (2,073 km²). • Protects the alluvial floodplain biodiversity of the Upper Ganga.
Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary	**Lalitpur District** (Deogarh)	**1977**; Area: **5.4 km²**	Leopards, Jackals, Nilgai, Wild Boar, Vultures	• **Smallest Wildlife Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh** (5.4 km²).
National Chambal Sanctuary	**Agra & Etawah Districts** (along Chambal River)	**1979**; Tri-state sanctuary (UP, MP, Rajasthan)	**Gharial** (*Gavialis gangeticus*), Red-crowned Roofed Turtle, Gangetic River Dolphin, Mugger Crocodile	• Special Riverine Sanctuary dedicated to the critically endangered fish-eating **Gharial** and freshwater Gangetic Dolphins.
Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary	**Bahraich District** (Terai belt)	**1975**; Area: **400 km²**	Gharials, Gangetic Dolphins, Tigers, Rhinoceros, Swamp Deer	• Part of Dudhwa TR; drained by the Girwa and Suheli rivers; premier habitat of Gangetic dolphins and gharials.
Kaimoor Wildlife Sanctuary	**Mirzapur & Sonbhadra Districts**	**1982**; Area: **500 km²**	Blackbuck, Chinkara, Leopards, Prehistoric Rock Paintings (*Lakhania Dari*)	• Forested sandstone plateau of the Kaimur Range overlooking the Son valley.
Sohagibarwa Wildlife Sanctuary	**Maharajganj District**	**1987**; Area: **428 km²**	Tigers, Leopards, Pythons, King Cobra, Water Monitor Lizard	• Situated on the international border with Nepal in the Terai lowland.
Suhelwa Wildlife Sanctuary	**Balrampur, Shravasti & Gonda**	**1988**; Area: **452 km²**	Leopards, Sloth Bears, Barking Deer, Jungle Cat	• Stretches along the Indo-Nepal international boundary.

Table 2: Complete Ramsar Wetlands Matrix of Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh possesses one of the largest concentrations of **Ramsar Wetlands of International Importance** in India:

Ramsar Site / Wetland	District / Location	Ramsar Inscription Date	Surface Area (Hectares)	Ecological Significance & Flagship Avifauna
1. Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora)	**Bulandshahr, Hapur, Sambhal, Amroha, Badaun**	**8 November 2005**	**26,590 ha**	• **First Ramsar Site of Uttar Pradesh** (stretch of 85 km on the Ganga). • Home to Gangetic Dolphins, Gharials, Muggers, Otters, 12 species of freshwater turtles.
2. Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary (Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad Bird Sanctuary)	**Unnao District** (Kanpur-Lucknow Road)	**19 September 2019**	**224.6 ha**	• Shallow monsoon-fed lake hosting >25,000 waterbirds; migratory Pintails, Greylag Geese, Mallards, and Cotton Teals.
3. Samaspur Bird Sanctuary	**Rae Bareli District** (Salon tehsil)	**19 September 2019**	**799.4 ha**	• Perennial lowland wetland consisting of 6 interconnected water bodies; supports vulnerable **Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*).
4. Sandi Bird Sanctuary	**Hardoi District**	**19 September 2019**	**308.5 ha**	• Natural freshwater marsh on the Garra River basin; critical drought refuge for Eurasian Wigeons and Red-crested Pochards.
5. Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary	**Gonda District**	**19 September 2019**	**722 ha**	• Permanent freshwater oxbow lake system comprising two lakes (Parvati and Arga); critical nesting ground for White-rumped Vultures.
6. Saman Bird Sanctuary	**Mainpuri District**	**19 September 2019**	**526.3 ha**	• Seasonal oxbow lake on the Ganga floodplain; vital stopover for Central Asian Flyway waterfowl and Sarus Cranes.
7. Sarsai Nawar Wetland	**Etawah District**	**19 September 2019**	**161.3 ha**	• Permanent marshland supporting the highest non-breeding congregation of the vulnerable **Sarus Crane** in South Asia.
8. Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)	**Agra District** (on Mathura Road)	**21 August 2020**	**431 ha**	• Man-made reservoir fed by Agra Canal; features a specialized **Bear Rescue Facility** and large breeding colonies of migratory waterfowl.
9. Haiderpur Wetland	**Muzaffarnagar & Bijnor Districts**	**8 December 2021**	**6,908 ha**	• Human-made wetland formed in 1984 by the construction of the Madhya Ganga Barrage within Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary; critical habitat for Swamp Deer and wintering migratory waterbirds.
10. Bakhira Bird Sanctuary	**Sant Kabir Nagar District**	**2 February 2022** (World Wetlands Day)	**2,894 ha**	• Largest natural flood-plain lake in Eastern UP; wintering refuge for over 40,000 birds across 30 species.
11. Shekha Jheel	**Aligarh District**	Designated Wetland / Ramsar Track	**25 ha**	• Fresh-water perennial lake adjacent to Upper Ganga Canal; sanctuary for winter migratory ducks.
12. Patna Bird Sanctuary	**Etah District** (Jalesar)	Designated Wetland / Wildlife Sanctuary	**109 ha**	• Notified sanctuary famous for dense water lily (*Kamal*) growth and massive congregation of wintering migratory birds.
13. Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary)	**Ballia District**	**5 June 2026** (World Environment Day)	**3,432 ha**	• Meandering floodplain oxbow lake near the Ganga-Saryu confluence; **India's 100th Ramsar Site**.

Table 3: Multimodal Transport Infrastructure of Uttar Pradesh

Infrastructure Segment	Key Highlights / Headquarter / Extent	Operating Scale / Total Network	Strategic Significance & Economic Impact
Operational Expressways	• **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km: Greater Noida–Agra) • **Agra-Lucknow Expressway** (302 km: Agra–Lucknow) • **Purvanchal Expressway** (340.8 km: Lucknow–Ghazipur) • **Bundelkhand Expressway** (296 km: Chitrakoot–Etawah) • **Delhi-Meerut Expressway** (96 km: 14-lane high-speed corridor)	Over **1,200 km** of operational 6-lane/4-lane access-controlled expressways	• UP is the **"Expressway State of India"**, accounting for >50% of the country's total operational expressway network.
Expressways Under Execution	• **Ganga Expressway** (594 km: Meerut–Prayagraj via 12 districts) • **Gorakhpur Link Expressway** (91.3 km: Jaitpur–Salarpur) • **Lucknow-Kanpur Expressway** (63 km) • **Chitrakoot-Prayagraj Link** & **Ganga Haridwar Extension**	Under construction by **UPEIDA**	• Transforms the logistics landscape by connecting Western UP directly to Purvanchal and Southern Bundelkhand.
International Airports	1. **Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport (Amausi, Lucknow)** 2. **Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport (Babatpur, Varanasi)** 3. **Kushinagar International Airport** (Declared Intl: June 2020) 4. **Maharishi Valmiki International Airport (Ayodhya Dham)** (Dec 2023) 5. **Noida International Airport (Jewar, GB Nagar)** (Commercial: June 2026)	**5 Operational / Developing International Airports** (Highest for any state in India)	• Direct international connectivity for religious tourism (Kashi, Ayodhya, Buddhist circuit) and global trade/cargo logistics in NCR.
Railway Zonal Headquarters	1. **North Eastern Railway (NER)**: Headquartered at **Gorakhpur** 2. **North Central Railway (NCR)**: Headquartered at **Prayagraj (Subedarganj)**	2 Railway Zonal HQs located inside UP	• UP has the **largest railway route kilometer network in India** (>8,800 route km). • Gorakhpur features one of the world's longest railway platforms (1,366.3 metres).
Inland Waterway (National Waterway 1 - NW-1)	**Prayagraj (UP) to Haldia (West Bengal)** along the Ganga River	**1,620 km** (Jal Marg Vikas Project - World Bank assisted)	• India's first National Waterway. • **Multimodal Freight Terminal** operational at **Ralhupur, Varanasi** and floating cargo terminals at Prayagraj and Ghazipur.
Urban Rapid Transit / Metro	Operational in **6 Cities**: **Lucknow, Kanpur, Agra, Noida-Greater Noida (Aqua Line), Ghaziabad, Meerut (Metro + Namo Bharat RRTS)**	India's premier State with 6 operational metro transit cities	• Namo Bharat (Regional Rapid Transit System - RRTS) links Delhi–Ghaziabad–Meerut with operational speeds of 160 ext{ km/h}.

One-Liner Revision – UP Transport, Tourism, Environment

#	Fast Fact
1	Purvanchal Expressway = **341 km** (Lucknow-Ghazipur); inaugurated Nov 2021

#	Fast Fact
2	Agra-Lucknow Expressway = **302 km**; inaugurated 2016
3	Yamuna Expressway = **165 km** (Delhi-Agra); 2012
4	Ganga Expressway = **594 km** (Meerut-Prayagraj); longest when complete
5	Bundelkhand Expressway = **296 km** (Chitrakoot-Etawah)
6	Lucknow Metro = first metro in UP (operational since **2017**)
7	Dudhwa National Park = famous for **Barasingha** and tigers
8	Pilibhit Tiger Reserve = terai forests; adjacent Nepal border
9	National Chambal Sanctuary = **Gharial** conservation
10	Katarniaghat WS (Bahraich) = Gangetic dolphin + gharial
11	UP = India's most lightning-prone State
12	Flood-prone districts = Bahraich, Lakhimpur Kheri, Gorakhpur
13	Drought-prone = **Bundelkhand** (Jhansi, Lalitpur, Banda)
14	UP State animal = **Barasingha** (swamp deer)
15	UP State bird = **Sarus Crane** (world's tallest flying bird)

Topic 8 — Current Affairs, Schemes and Miscellaneous

Consolidated — 50 Must-Score Facts

1. **Uttar Pradesh Diwas (UP Day)** is officially celebrated every year on **24 January**.
2. On **24 January 1950**, the United Provinces was officially renamed as **Uttar Pradesh**.
3. The official **State Seal / Emblem** of Uttar Pradesh was formally adopted in **1938**.
4. The State Emblem of UP incorporates a **Bow and Arrow** (Lord Rama), a **Pair of Fish** (Nawabs of Awadh), and **Three Flowing Streams** (Triveni Sangam).
5. The **State Animal** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Swamp Deer (Barasingha)** (*Rucervus duvaucelii*).
6. The **State Bird** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*).
7. The **State Tree** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Ashoka (Sita Ashoka)** (*Saraca asoca*).
8. The **State Flower** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Palash / Dhak / Tesu** (*Butea monosperma*).
9. **Palash** was officially declared as the State Flower on **4 January 2011**, replacing Brahmakamal.
10. The **State Aquatic Animal** of Uttar Pradesh is the **Gangetic River Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*).
11. The financial assistance under **Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana** is provided in **6 distinct stages**, totaling **₹25,000**.
12. Under Kanya Sumangala Yojana, the annual family income ceiling is capped at **₹3 Lakh**.
13. The **Mukhyamantri Abhyudaya Yojana** was launched on **Basant Panchami in February 2021** to provide free competitive exam coaching.
14. The **Vishwakarma Shram Samman Yojana** provides free 6-day skill training, modern toolkits, and subsidized bank loans to traditional village craftsmen.
15. The **Swami Vivekananda Youth Empowerment Scheme** distributes free smartphones and tablets to final-year college/technical students.
16. The **Nand Baba Milk Mission** was launched with an outlay of **₹1,000 Crore** in **June 2023** to boost indigenous bovine milk output.
17. The **Nandini Krishak Samriddhi Yojana** provides a 50% capital subsidy for establishing 25-cow dairy farms of indigenous breeds.
18. **Kamdhenu Dairy Yojana** is an older standalone scheme and is **NOT** a component of the current Nand Baba Milk Mission.
19. Under the **UP Krishak Durghatna Kalyan Yojana**, compensation of **₹5 Lakh** is provided for accidental death or permanent disability of farmers.
20. **Mission Shakti** was launched during Shardiya Navratri in **October 2020** to ensure women's security, dignity, and self-reliance.
21. Dedicated **Women Help Desks (Mahila Helpdesk)** have been set up in all **1,535+ police stations** across Uttar Pradesh.
22. **Nivesh Mitra** is Uttar Pradesh's flagship digital single-window portal for industrial clearances and investor facilitation.
23. The **UP Gaurav Samman** is the highest state civilian honor, carrying a cash prize of **₹11 Lakh**.
24. The highest Hindi literary award of the Uttar Pradesh Hindi Sansthan is the **Bharat Bharti Puraskar**, carrying a cash award of **₹8 Lakh**.
25. The first recipient of the prestigious Bharat Bharti Puraskar was **Mahadevi Varma (1982)**.
26. The highest sports awards in Uttar Pradesh are the **Laxman Award (for Men)** and **Rani Lakshmibai Award (for Women)**, carrying a cash prize of **₹3.11 Lakh**.
27. **Smt. Sarojini Naidu** was the **First Woman Governor** of Uttar Pradesh and in India (1947–1949).
28. **Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant** was the **First Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh (1950–1954).
29. **Smt. Sucheta Kripalani** was the **First Woman Chief Minister** of Uttar Pradesh and in India (1963–1967).

30. The first Chief Justice of the High Court of Judicature at Agra (1866) was **Sir Walter Morgan**.
31. The first Indian Chief Justice of the Allahabad High Court after independence was **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik**.
32. The first Lokayukta of Uttar Pradesh was **Justice Vishwambhar Dayal** (appointed September 1977).
33. India's first modern vacuum-pan sugar mill was established in **1903 at Pratappur in Deoria district**.
34. The **Yamuna Expressway** (165 km) was the first access-controlled super expressway built in Uttar Pradesh.
35. The world's longest river cruise, **MV Ganga Vilas**, was flagged off from **Varanasi** to Dibrugarh (via Bangladesh) in **January 2023**.
36. **Varanasi** was declared the first **Cultural and Tourism Capital of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)** for 2022–2023.
37. **Kannauj** is known as the **"Attar Nagari"** and the **"Grasse of the East"**.
38. **Firozabad** is famous as **"Suhag Nagari"** and the **"Glass City of India"**.
39. **Moradabad** is internationally renowned as **"Peetal Nagari" (Brass City)**.
40. **Aligarh** is known as **"Taala Nagari" (City of Locks)**.
41. **Bhadohi** is celebrated as the **"Carpet City" (Kaleen Nagari)**.
42. **Kanpur** was historically called the **"Manchester of the East"** and the **"Leather City of the World"**.
43. **Jaunpur** was nicknamed **"Shiraz-e-Hind"** during the Sharqi Sultanate.
44. **Meerut** is known as **"Kranti Nagar"** (1857 spark) and **"Kainchi Nagari" (Scissor City)**.
45. **Pratapgarh** is renowned as **"Aonla Nagari"** (Gooseberry Capital).
46. **Malihabad (Lucknow)** is celebrated as the **"Mango City"** for its world-famous Dasheri mango orchards.
47. **Sonbhadra** is known as the **"Energy Capital of India"** due to its pithead mega thermal power plants.
48. Under the **One District One Cuisine (ODOC)** scheme launched in 2026, signature traditional culinary dishes of all 75 districts are branded and promoted.
49. The **Ramnagar Ramlila of Varanasi** (2008) and **Kumbh Mela of Prayagraj** (2017) are inscribed on **UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage List**.
50. North India's first hyperscale data centre, **Yotta D1**, was inaugurated at **Greater Noida** in 2022.

📋 Must-score drill — master tables

Table 1: Flagship Government Welfare Schemes & Mission Programmes of Uttar Pradesh

Scheme / Mission Name	Launch Year / Administering Dept	Target Beneficiary Group	Financial Assistance / Key Provisions	Core Objectives & Impact
Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana	**2019** (Women and Child Development Dept)	Girl child from families with annual income \le ₹3 ext{ Lakh} (Max 2 girls per family)	Graded monetary support in **6 stages** (expanded to **₹25,000** total across birth, vaccination, school admissions, and higher education degree enrollment).	• Eliminates female feticide and girl child abandonment. • Promotes institutional deliveries, complete immunization, and higher education retention for girls.
Mukhyamantri Abhyudaya Yojana	**February 2021** (Basant Panchami / Social Welfare Dept)	Meritorious and economically underprivileged youth preparing for competitive exams (UPPSC, UPSC, NEET, JEE, NDA, CDS)	Free high-quality classroom coaching, digital study tablets, guest lectures by IAS/IPS officers, and virtual LMS platforms across all 18 divisional headquarters and 75 districts.	• Levels the playing field for rural/poor students lacking funds for private commercial coaching.

Scheme / Mission Name	Launch Year / Administering Dept	Target Beneficiary Group	Financial Assistance / Key Provisions	Core Objectives & Impact
Vishwakarma Shram Samman Yojana	**2019** (MSME and Export Promotion Dept)	Traditional village and urban artisans, craftsmen (Barbers, Carpenters, Blacksmiths, Cobblers, Tailors, Potters, Weavers)	6 days of free skill-upgradation training, stipend, and **100% subsidized advanced modern toolkit bags** + bank loan linkages up to ₹10 Lakh without collateral.	• Prevents distress migration. • Modernizes traditional family-based micro-enterprises and integrates them with MSME value chains.
Swami Vivekananda Youth Empowerment Scheme	**December 2021** (IT & Electronics Dept)	Final-year students enrolled in Higher Education, Technical, Medical, Polytechnic, ITI, and Skill Development courses	Free distribution of modern **Smartphones and Tablets** pre-loaded with digital educational content, employment portals, and skill development apps.	• Bridges the digital divide among youth and enables seamless access to online higher education and job opportunities.
Nand Baba Milk Mission	**June 2023** (Dairy Development Dept; Outlay: ₹1,000 Crore)	Dairy farmers, cattle rearers, and rural youth	Groups three key schemes: 1. **Nandini Krishak Samriddhi Yojana** (subsidies up to 50% for 25-cow dairy units). 2. **Mukhyamantri Swadeshi Gau-Samvardhan Yojana** (incentives for buying Gir, Sahiwal, Tharparkar indigenous cows). 3. **Mukhyamantri Pragatisheel Pashupalak Protsahan Yojana**.	• Enhances milk productivity of indigenous bovine breeds. • Boosts milk processing through village-level Dairy Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs).
Mukhyamantri Yuva Swarojgar Yojana	**2018** (Directorate of Industries)	Educated unemployed youth (18–40 years; minimum High School pass)	Margin money subsidy of 25% (up to ₹6.25 Lakh for industrial projects costing up to ₹25 Lakh; up to ₹2.5 Lakh for service sector up to ₹10 Lakh).	• Promotes local micro-entrepreneurship and self-employment generation in semi-urban and rural areas.
Mission Shakti (Phases 1 to 5)	**October 2020 (Navratri)** (Home, Police & Women Welfare Dept)	Women and girls across all 75 districts	Setting up **Women Helpdesks** in all 1,535+ police stations, Pink Booths, Pink Patrol vehicles, emergency helplines (1090 Women Powerline, 112 ERSS, 181, 1098), and anti-Romeo squads.	• Comprehensive multi-departmental drive ensuring safety, dignity, security, and economic self-reliance (*Suraksha, Samman, Swavalamban*) for women.
Mukhyamantri Khet Talab Yojana	**2018** (Agriculture & Minor Irrigation Dept)	Farmers of drought-prone **Bundelkhand** and Vindhyan region	50% direct subsidy for excavating farm ponds (Khet Talab) on private agricultural land.	• Harvesting rainwater, reviving groundwater aquifers, and providing critical supplemental irrigation.
UP Krishak Durghatna Kalyan Yojana	**2020** (Revenue Dept)	Farmers, agricultural laborers, and bataidars (18–70 years)	Financial compensation of **₹5 Lakh** in case of accidental death or permanent total disability during farming operations.	• Complete social security safety net for agrarian families.

Table 2: Official State Symbols, Emblems, State Days and Traditional District Nicknames

State Symbol / Element	Official Name / Latin Nomenclature	Year of Adoption / Description	Cultural, Historical & Ecological Significance
State Seal / Emblem	**Circular Seal with Bow-Arrow, Twin Fish and Tri-stream Confluence**	Adopted in **1938**	• **Bow and Arrow (*Dhanush-Baan*)**: Symbolizes Lord Rama and the valorous heritage of Awadh/Ayodhya. • **Pair of Fish (*Matsya*)**: Symbolizes the Nawabs of Awadh (emblem of royal sovereignty derived from the Mughal *Mahi-o-Maratib*). • **Three Wave Lines**: Symbolizes the holy confluence of **Ganga, Yamuna, and mythical Saraswati** at Prayagraj.
State Animal	**Swamp Deer (Barasingha)** (*Rucervus duvaucelii*)	Declared official State Animal	• Endemic to the moist alluvial grassland and swamp ecosystem of the Terai belt; protected core population thrives in **Dudhwa National Park**.
State Bird	**Sarus Crane** (*Antigone antigone*)	Declared official State Bird	• World's tallest flying bird; revered as a lifelong symbol of marital fidelity and devotion. Over 70% of India's Sarus population lives in the wetlands of South-Western and Central UP (Mainpuri, Etawah, Auraiya).
State Tree	**Ashoka (Sita Ashoka)** (*Saraca asoca*)	Declared official State Tree	• Sacred indigenous evergreen rainforest tree associated with the Ramayana (Ashoka Vatika); famous for fragrant orange-yellow blossoms.
State Flower	**Palash / Dhak / Tesu** (*Butea monosperma*)	Declared on **4 January 2011** (replaced Brahmakamal)	• Known as the "Flame of the Forest"; blooms with vibrant fiery red-orange flowers during spring across the Vindhyan and Bundelkhand scrublands.
State Aquatic Animal	**Gangetic River Dolphin (Susu)** (*Platanista gangetica*)	Re-affirmed in **October 2023**	• National and State aquatic animal; apex biological indicator of freshwater health in the Ganga, Yamuna, Chambal, and Geruwa rivers.
State Day (UP Diwas)	**24 January**	Notification dated 24 Jan 1950 (Celebrated since **2018**)	• Commemorates the historic signing of the United Provinces (Alteration of Name) Order, 1950, renaming the state as **Uttar Pradesh**.

Master Table of Traditional District Nicknames & Epithets of Uttar Pradesh

District / City	Traditional Nickname / Cultural Epithet	District / City	Traditional Nickname / Cultural Epithet
Varanasi	*City of Light (Kashi), City of Ghats, Cultural Capital of India, Mokshapuri*	**Prayagraj**	*Sangam Nagari, Tirthraj, Kumbh Nagari, Amrud Nagari (City of Guavas)*
Kannauj	*Attar Nagari (Perfume City), Grasse of the East, Mahodaya Shri, Kanyakubja*	**Kanpur**	*Manchester of the East, Leather City of the World, Industrial Capital of UP*
Moradabad	*Peetal Nagari (Brass City)*	**Firozabad**	*Suhag Nagari, Glass City of India, Chudi Nagari*
Aligarh	*Taala Nagari (City of Locks), Harigarh*	**Bhadohi**	*Carpet City (Kaleen Nagari)*
Lucknow	*City of Nawabs, City of Gardens (Baghon ka Shahar), Shiraz-e-Awadh*	**Jaunpur**	*Shiraz-e-Hind* (for medieval art and learning)
Mathura	*Krishna Nagari, Peda Nagari, City of Temples*	**Ayodhya**	*Ram Nagari, Saket, City of Temples*
Agra	*Taj Nagari, Petha Nagari, Leather Footwear Capital*	**Bareilly**	*Surma Nagari, Jhumka City, Bans Bareilly*
Meerut	*Kranti Nagar (City of Revolution), Sports City of India, Scissor City (Kainchi Nagari)*	**Saharanpur**	*Woodcraft City (Nakkashi Nagari)*
Pratapgarh	*Aonla Nagari (Gooseberry Capital)*	**Malihabad (Lucknow)**	*Mango City (Aam Nagari)*

District / City	Traditional Nickname / Cultural Epithet	District / City	Traditional Nickname / Cultural Epithet
Sonbhadra	*Energy Capital of India, Switzerland of Uttar Pradesh*	**Hathras**	*Hing Nagari (Asafoetida City), Mahamaya Nagar*

Table 3: State Honors, Literary Awards, Sports Honors & Institutional Firsts

Award / Honor / First	Conferred By / Associated Field	Cash Prize / Distinction	Historic Firsts & Notable Laureates
UP Gaurav Samman	Government of Uttar Pradesh (Replaced Yash Bharti)	**₹11 Lakh** + Citation	• Highest civil honor of the Government of UP; awarded annually to eminent achievers across science, agriculture, arts, and entrepreneurship.
Bharat Bharti Puraskar	**Uttar Pradesh Hindi Sansthan (Lucknow)**	**₹8 Lakh** (Highest Hindi literary award of UP)	• Conferred for lifetime contribution to Hindi literature. • First recipient: **Mahadevi Varma** (1982). Other titans: Dharmavir Bharati, Vidya Niwas Mishra.
Laxman Award & Rani Lakshmibai Award	**UP Sports Department**	**₹3.11 Lakh** (enhanced) + Bronze Statue	• **Laxman Award**: Highest sports award of UP for outstanding male sportspersons. • **Rani Lakshmibai Award**: Highest sports award of UP for outstanding female sportspersons.
First Governor of UP	Constitutional Executive	Smt. **Sarojini Naidu**	• Served 15 August 1947 to 2 March 1949 (First woman Governor of an Indian State).
First Chief Minister of UP	Democratic Executive	Pandit **Govind Ballabh Pant**	• Served 26 January 1950 to 27 December 1954 (Premier of United Provinces since 1937).
First Woman Chief Minister	Democratic Executive	Smt. **Sucheta Kripalani**	• Served October 1963 to March 1967 (First woman Chief Minister in India).
First Chief Justice of High Court	Judiciary (Agra/Allahabad)	**Sir Walter Morgan** (1866)	• First Indian CJ post-independence: **Justice Bidhu Bhushan Malik** (1947).
First Lokayukta of UP	Anti-Corruption Ombudsman	**Justice Vishwambhar Dayal**	• Appointed in September 1977 under the UP Lokayukta and Up-Lokayuktas Act, 1975.
First Modern Sugar Mill	Industrial History	**Pratappur (Deoria)**	• Established in **1903**, pioneering the modern vacuum-pan sugar industry in India.
First Access-Controlled Expressway	Road Infrastructure	**Yamuna Expressway**	• 165-km 6-lane expressway connecting Greater Noida to Agra (operational 2012).
First UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage from UP	Global Cultural Recognition	**Ramnagar Ramlila** (2008) & **Kumbh Mela** (2017)	• Inscribed on UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.

One-Liner Revision – UP Schemes and Current Affairs

#	Fast Fact
1	GIS 2023 MoU = **Rs 33.5 lakh crore** (Feb 2023, Lucknow)
2	Kashi Vishwanath Corridor inaugurated = **13 Dec 2021**
3	Ram Mandir Ayodhya inaugurated = **22 Jan 2024**
4	Kushinagar Airport = International airport; Oct 2021
5	Jewar Airport = **Gautam Buddha Nagar**; India's largest (planned)
6	UP Defence Corridor = **Lucknow-Agra** + **Jhansi-Aligarh**

#	Fast Fact
7	Ganga Expressway = **594 km** (Meerut-Prayagraj); longest in India
8	UP Film City = proposed in **Noida Sector 21**
9	Maha Kumbh 2025 = **Prayagraj**
10	UP Smart Cities = Lucknow, Agra, Varanasi, Kanpur, Prayagraj, Bareilly, Aligarh
11	DefExpo 2020, 2022 = held in **Lucknow**
12	Purvanchal Expressway inauguration = **November 2021**
13	Bundelkhand Expressway inaugurated = **July 2022**
14	Mission Shakti (UP) = women safety and empowerment (2020)
15	UP CM Abhyudaya Yojana = free coaching for **IAS, NEET, JEE**